

Art Book - Collection Overview

Dr. Elena Vasquez

Former computational biologist turned artist, Vasquez creates works that reveal the mathematical structures underlying natural forms and explore the boundaries between organic life and digital existence. Working between Barcelona, Woods Hole, and the Galapagos Islands.

Elena Vasquez spent fifteen years modeling protein folding algorithms before she realized that the most interesting questions weren't computational — they were sculptural. Her background in mathematical biology infuses every piece with an understanding of how numbers emerge from living systems and how living systems can be reconstituted from numbers. She treats fossils as compressed data, shells as hardware for mathematical theorems, and artificial intelligence as a form of digital necromancy. Critics have described her work as 'rigorously speculative' and 'scientifically mystical,' terms she considers accurate. Her installations occupy the uncertain territory between laboratory and chapel, where mathematical proof and emotional truth become difficult to distinguish.

Series: Computational Paleontology

Primordial Stones (2023)

Technique: Microcontroller unit, stone arrangements, LED lighting, numeric input interface

Display: Gallery or museum dark room installation

Stone arrangements representing prime numbers that illuminate to reveal the prime factorization of any number entered by visitors, showing how all numbers are 'born' from these fundamental building blocks.

There is something profoundly human about the desire to find pattern in stone. Vasquez taps into this ancient impulse and runs it through a microcontroller that reveals mathematical truth. The sets of stones sit in relative darkness — patient, geological, indifferent — each set containing a prime number of stones. When visitors enter any number through the keypad, only the sets of stones corresponding to that number's prime factors illuminate, glowing like amber genealogy. Enter 12, and the sets of stones for 2 and 3 light up ($2^2 \times 3$). Enter 77, and the sets for 7 and 11 announce themselves. The piece demonstrates that every number in existence is born from these primordial elements, that complexity emerges from fundamental simplicity. It is a meditation on mathematical genesis rendered in stone and light.

Prime Shell Spiral (2024)

Technique: Brass sculpture, engraved prime numbers, nautilus shell form, large scale fabrication

Display: Museum plinth display or outdoor sculpture garden

A monumental 5-meter-tall brass sculpture in the form of a nautilus shell with prime numbers engraved inside, demonstrating the perfect correlation between the shell's natural growth and prime number distribution.

The nautilus shell embodies nature's understanding of logarithmic spirals — a mathematical relationship that predates human civilization by hundreds of millions of years. Vasquez takes this ancient biological computer and inscribes it with the prime number sequence, revealing a stunning natural correlation. At the center of the shell sits a single large prime number, while progressively smaller primes populate the expanding outer chambers in increasing quantities, culminating with the number one at the very edge. This distribution perfectly mirrors the mathematical reality that larger prime numbers are rare while smaller primes are abundant. Standing 5 meters tall, the sculpture demonstrates that the nautilus shell's natural growth pattern is mathematically identical to prime number distribution — as if nature itself understands this fundamental mathematical truth. Visitors can walk around the monumental sculpture and climb steps to trace the spiral, experiencing how biological form and mathematical law converge into the same elegant pattern. The piece asks whether mathematics governs nature or nature reveals mathematics, and suggests the distinction might be meaningless.

AI Fish Resurrection (2025)

Technique: Fossil photography, multimodal LLM image reconstruction, image to 3D model generation, automated rigging, water animation simulation, real time rendering

Display: Museum installation with the fossil shown beside a screen displaying the reconstructed fish swimming in a digital water environment

A camera captures a fossil, an AI imagines it as a living fish, that image is turned into a 3D model, the model is rigged automatically, and the fish is animated in water.

A camera takes a picture of a fish fossil. A multimodal language model interprets the fossil and generates an image of what the living specimen might have looked like. That generated image is passed into an image to 3D model tool, which produces a three dimensional fish form. An automated rigging system prepares the body for movement, and the fish is then placed into a simulated water environment where it swims in real time. The work presents a simple chain of transformation from fossil trace to living digital presence, using accessible AI tools to move from documentation to imagination, from image to body, and from body to motion.

Perceptron 195X (2024)

Technique: Microcontroller, touch-sensitive 10x10 light bulb grid, weight indicator LEDs, YES/NO/TRAIN/TEST interface

Display: Interactive gallery installation, mid-room pedestal

A 10x10 grid of touch-sensitive light bulbs allows visitors to draw patterns, label them YES or NO, and watch a perceptron machine learn in real time through visible LED weight indicators.

Named after Frank Rosenblatt's 1957 invention, this piece collapses seventy years of machine learning into a grid you can touch. The visitor draws. Labels. Trains. Watches. The machine learns, visibly, its shifting weights rendered in amber LEDs. It is endearingly stupid at first — wrong more than it is right, like most of us — and then suddenly, improbably, it begins to agree with you. Whether this constitutes intelligence, art, or an elaborate tutorial on linear classification is a question Vasquez leaves

open. The large YES lamp at the top glows with a warmth that borders on affection.

Prime Distribution (2022)

Technique: Microcontroller, audible tone generator, blinking light, algorithmic prime number sweep

Display: Dark gallery room, single pedestal installation

A sweeping counter from 1 to N activates a light and sound only at prime numbers, creating an increasingly sparse rhythm as the sequence progresses.

Prime Distribution is perhaps the most austere piece in Vasquez's practice and the most honest. A light blinks. A tone sounds. Less and less frequently. The silence between primes grows. The universe spreads out. There is no metaphor here that is not also mathematics. The piece enacts in blinking light and occasional sound the precise rate at which meaning becomes more rare as scale increases. Whether this is a meditation on loneliness, cosmology, or number theory is a distinction Vasquez refuses to make.

Valentina Cienfuegos Mora

Born in Oaxaca and trained in Mexico City and Paris, Cienfuegos Mora creates politically charged sculptures, installations, and paintings centering pre-Hispanic mythology, resistance movements, and the collision between ancient cosmology and contemporary capital.

Valentina Cienfuegos Mora makes work that is not interested in your comfort. Her sculptures invoke Coatlicue and capital in the same breath. Her paintings sit somewhere between cosmic and street-level, between the sacred and the deeply sarcastic. She is the rare contemporary artist who can produce a tortilla dough human figure and have it read simultaneously as political statement, cultural preservation act, and gentle absurdist joke. Critics have accused her work of being too didactic, too poetic, too Mexican, and not Mexican enough — which she considers a satisfactory range of responses.

Water(s) (2022)

Technique: Ocean water, 1950s crystal flasks, archival display

Display: Gallery vitrine or shelf display, paired flasks lying horizontal

Ocean water from Mexico and from the United States, taken from either side of the same border, displayed lying down in elegant 1950s crystal flasks.

The water is chemically identical. The border is a line that does not exist in the water. Cienfuegos Mora takes samples from the same ocean at two adjacent national edges and presents them in the kind of glassware that was designed to make contents look precious. The flasks lie down — horizontal, at rest, refusing the upright declaration of a monument. The labels are exact about coordinates. The water is exact about indifference. The border between them exists only in the space between the flasks, which is a gap of perhaps fifteen centimeters.

Angel vs. Capital (2023)

Technique: Metal sculpture, architectural-scale installation, two-figure composition

Display: Public square outdoor installation or large gallery space

The Angel of Independence confronts a column representing capital, or is seized by a demonic figure embodying it — a confrontation between national symbol and economic power.

Mexico City's Angel of Independence is already a monument to myth-making — gold-leafed, triumphant, built on a Porfirian budget over indigenous bones. Cienfuegos Mora places it in direct confrontation with its true adversary: not a foreign army but an economic logic. The demon of capital either flanks the angel or seizes it outright, depending on the installation version. There is no ambiguity about who is winning. What Cienfuegos Mora leaves open is whether the angel notices.

Cyberpunk Tenochtitlan (2024)

Technique: Scale model, mixed materials, LED lighting, laser-cut miniature details, custom figurines

Display: Museum installation in large vitrine or open gallery table

Detailed scale models of Mexico City locations where pre-Hispanic gods walk alongside cyborgs and shamans, with science-fiction taco stands receiving ingredients through pneumatic tubes and drones.

This is, on its surface, a scale model. It is also a political document, a love letter, a grievance, and a projection of everything that Mexico City already is — just rendered visible. Quetzalcoatl shares a street corner with a cyborg in a Virgen de Guadalupe hoodie. A taquero receives masa via pneumatic tube from a drone the shape of a Tlaloc mask. The model does not imagine a future. It describes the present with the volume turned up. Cienfuegos Mora has said she builds it from the city she grew up in, which is either deeply nostalgic or profoundly accurate — probably both.

Zapatista Women Sculptures (2023)

Technique: Cast metal sculpture, traditional textile color elements, miniature version included

Display: Museum gallery or outdoor public installation, series of seven

Seven metal sculptures of Zapatista women, each adorned with a bright item of traditional indigenous clothing. A miniature version of the full series is also produced.

Seven is not an accidental number. Cienfuegos Mora's Zapatista women stand in the pose of neither aggression nor submission — they stand in the pose of people who have decided. Each figure wears a single bright garment element sourced from different indigenous traditions of southern Mexico, the colors doing the work that the masked faces refuse to do. The miniature version — identical in every detail but small enough to hold — is perhaps the more quietly devastating of the two scales, turning public monument into private talisman.

Indigenous Women of the World (2024)

Technique: Cast bronze sculpture series, single traditional garment element per figure in vivid color, series of seven with miniature version

Display: Museum gallery or outdoor public installation, series of seven with optional miniature version

Seven bronze sculptures of women from indigenous peoples across the world - Maasai, Flower Hmong, Sami, Kayapo, Yoruba, Quechua, and Kuna - each figure defined by a single brilliant traditional garment. A miniature version of the full series is also produced.

Seven is not an accidental number, and neither is one. Cienfuegos Mora's series pairs the global breadth of seven indigenous women with the discipline of a single garment per figure - a formal constraint that places the clothing item in conversation with the body rather than overwhelming it. Each figure stands with the particular stillness of a person who knows exactly who they are. The Maasai woman from the Great Rift Valley of Kenya and Tanzania wears the red shuka - a rectangular plaid cloth in solid scarlet, traditionally signaling courage and protection from predators, draped over one shoulder in the manner of semi-nomadic Nilotic communities who have inhabited this territory for centuries and whose population numbers approximately 900,000 across both nations. The Flower Hmong woman from the highland valleys of northern Vietnam and Laos wears only her embroidered pleated skirt - a batik-dyed hemp garment representing over 200 hours of cross-stitch embroidery in hot pink, jade green, and electric blue; the Flower Hmong, also called Hmong Leng, are one of over 60 Hmong sub-groups and take their name from the extraordinary floral density of this textile tradition, which is considered among the most technically demanding of any living highland culture in Southeast Asia. The Sami woman from Arctic Scandinavia stands in her royal-blue gakti - the structured traditional tunic of the Kautokeino style, with red, yellow, and green ribbon trim that identifies her home community and marital status; the Sami are the only recognized indigenous people of Arctic Scandinavia, having inhabited the region for at least 5,000 years, and the gakti encodes genealogy, geography, and personal history in a single garment. The Kayapo woman from the Brazilian states of Para and Mato Grosso wears only her crimson macaw-feather ngopokati crown - a headdress of scarlet macaw tail feathers worn in ceremonies marking births and seasonal cycles; the Kayapo number approximately 11,000 across more than 30 villages and have led major international campaigns

to defend their Amazonian territory since the 1980s, making the headdress a mark not only of ceremony but of ongoing resistance. The Yoruba woman from southwestern Nigeria stands beneath an immense golden gele - the elaborate head wrap whose architectural pleats and peaks a skilled tier can raise thirty centimeters above the head; the Yoruba number over 40 million and their diaspora communities in Cuba, Brazil, and the Caribbean carried the gele into traditions of adornment that persist in multiple continents. The Quechua woman from the Andean highlands of Peru wears a blazing fuchsia pollera - the multilayered skirt in vivid wool whose specific color identifies village origin and ceremonial role among approximately 10 million Quechua speakers, the principal heirs of the Inca Empire, Tawantinsuyu, whose Runasimi language remains a living tongue across four countries. The Kuna woman from Panama's Caribbean San Blas archipelago wears her mola blouse - a textile panel of reverse applique in red, orange, and turquoise, layers of cotton cut and folded into intricate sea-turtle and geometric patterns worn daily; the Kuna people number approximately 80,000 and in 1925 won semi-autonomous governance of Guna Yala through the Guna Revolution, one of the few successful indigenous sovereignty movements of the twentieth century.

Indigenous Men of the World (2025)

Technique: Cast bronze sculpture series, single traditional male garment or adornment element per figure in vivid color, series of seven

Display: Museum gallery or outdoor public installation, series of seven, companion piece to Indigenous Women of the World

Seven bronze sculptures of men from indigenous peoples across the world - Maasai warrior, Huli Wigman, Dinka, Konyak Naga, Mapuche, Tuareg, and Yoruba chief - each figure defined by a single brilliant traditional garment or ceremonial adornment.

The companion series maintains the formal discipline of the female series - one figure, one garment - while acknowledging that in many of the same cultures, male ceremonial dress carries equal or greater cultural load. The Maasai warrior from the Great Rift Valley stands wearing only the ochre-dyed red shuka of a moran - the warrior-class of young men between circumcision and marriage charged with community protection, their long hair dyed rust-red with ochre clay; among the Maasai, the moran's red shuka is as much a social rank as a garment. The Huli Wigman from the Hela Province of the Southern Highlands of Papua New Guinea stands in

ceremonial pose, his single adornment the extraordinary ambua wig - a structure grown from the man's own hair over two years and decorated with yellow and red bird-of-paradise plumes and chrysanthemum flowers; among the Huli people of approximately 150,000, a man's wig is both autobiography and social credential, worn at sing-sing ceremonies that draw communities from across the highlands. The Dinka man from the Nile basin of South Sudan stands wearing only his malual beaded corset - a tight garment of hundreds of glass beads in bright pink, red, and blue worn during coming-of-age ceremonies to signal age-set and ceremonial status; the Dinka are the largest ethnic group of South Sudan at 4 to 5 million people, are among the tallest peoples on earth, and their beadwork traditions carry precise social codes invisible to outside observers. The Konyak Naga warrior from the Mon district of Nagaland in Northeast India stands in the tsungkotepsu - the woven warrior's shawl in black with broad red and yellow border bands, historically worn only by men who had taken enemy heads in battle; the Konyak, numbering approximately 250,000, maintained active headhunting traditions until Indian independence in 1947 and the tattooed faces and brass ornaments of the last elder headhunters became some of the most photographed human faces of the twentieth century. The Mapuche warrior from south-central Chile stands in a deep indigo makun - the large rectangular woolen poncho dyed with Chilean elderberry, trayen, and woven by Mapuche women in geometric kalul patterns encoding cosmological meaning; the Mapuche are the indigenous people of approximately 1.5 million who successfully resisted both Inca and Spanish conquest for over 300 years in what became known as the Arauco War, the longest indigenous resistance in the Americas. The Tuareg man from the central Sahara stands swathed in a single cobalt-blue tagelmust - the long indigo cotton cloth wound around the head and face whose deep plant-based dye transfers permanently to the skin, earning Tuareg men the name 'blue men of the desert'; among the approximately 2 million Tuareg across Mali, Niger, Algeria, Libya, and Burkina Faso, the tagelmust is dignity itself and its removal in public a gesture of profound vulnerability. The Yoruba chief from southwestern Nigeria stands in an emerald-green agbada - the immense flowing robe requiring up to 6 meters of fabric with elaborate gold-thread dansiki embroidery at the chest and sleeves that pool at his feet; among the Yoruba of over 40 million people, the agbada is the garment of men of standing, its volume and embroidery announcing presence before a word is spoken.

Indigenous People of the World (2025)

Technique: Cast bronze sculpture series, single vivid traditional garment or adornment per figure, applied mineral pigment and enamel for ceremonial makeup and body paint where culturally central, series of seven

Display: Museum gallery, series of seven, intended for display as a self-contained group and in dialogue with the Indigenous Women and Indigenous Men series

Seven bronze figures - men and women - chosen from indigenous peoples across five continents for the singular visual force of a single garment or adornment: the most colorful, the most architecturally bold, the most irreplaceable mark of a living culture.

This is not a survey. It is a selection made on purely aesthetic grounds - which is to say, on the grounds that matter most when the subject is adornment. Cienfuegos Mora spent two years narrowing the world's indigenous textile and body art traditions to seven that could each carry an entire bronze figure on the strength of a single item. The result covers five continents and includes one community from her own state of Chiapas, a deliberate anchor for the global reach of the rest. The Zinacantán Tzotzil woman from the highland community of Sots'lel, approximately 10 kilometers from San Cristóbal de las Casas in Chiapas and home to around 40,000 Tzotzil Maya speakers, wears her blusa bordada - a hand-embroidered blouse whose entire surface is dense with silk thread flowers in the specific palette that identifies Zinacantán: hot fuchsia, electric orange, deep red, and acid yellow on a white or dark ground, the mariposa and floral motifs worked in such density that the base cloth is almost invisible; Zinacantán is also the primary flower-growing community of the Chiapas highlands, supplying blooms for markets and ceremonies across the region, and the embroidered blouse carries this identity literally on its surface, the flowers worn and the flowers sold becoming a single gesture. The Huli man from the Hela Province in the Southern Highlands of Papua New Guinea stands in his ambua wig - a structure grown from his own hair over two to three years, shaped on a wooden frame and decorated with yellow and red bird-of-paradise plumes, white cockatoo feathers, and fresh chrysanthemum flowers renewed before each sing-sing ceremony; among the approximately 150,000 Huli people his face is painted with yellow and red ochre in the specific patterns that signal he is ready to be judged beautiful, his single additional adornment a crescent of polished

pearl shell at his chest. The Wodaabe man from the Ferlo basin of Niger stands in full Gerewol regalia - his face painted over two hours with red ochre base, yellow line down the nose bridge to lengthen it, kohl-black rings around the eyes to make the whites blaze, lips blackened to near-indigo to set off his teeth; the Gerewol competition, held annually at the end of the rainy season when cattle have fattened and trading partners gather, is a week-long ceremony in which men in full makeup compete before panels of young women who choose whom they find most beautiful, one of the few documented traditions globally where this evaluative direction is formalized as a social institution, and among the approximately 100,000 Wodaabe of the Sahel the quality of one's Gerewol face is a matter of serious lifelong practice. The Kayapo woman from the Rio Xingu basin of the Brazilian state of Para stands in her ngopokati headdress of scarlet macaw tail feathers and her body painted from crown to ankle with genipap and red urucu in the dense black geometric spirals and curvilinear patterns that identify her as a ceremonially active member of her village; among the approximately 11,000 Kayapo across more than 30 villages, body paint is not ornament but identity - the patterns distinguish village, age-set, and ritual role, and a woman without paint at a ceremony is a woman who has not yet arrived; the scarlet and orange of her macaw feathers against the black of the genipap body paint is among the most formally considered color combinations in any living visual tradition. The Flower Hmong woman from the highland valleys of Ha Giang province in northern Vietnam stands in her embroidered hemp skirt - a pleated garment whose every panel represents over 200 hours of batik-dyeing and cross-stitch embroidery in hot pink, jade green, lemon yellow, and electric blue, the floral and geometric density of the Flower Hmong, or Hmong Leng, textile tradition considered among the most technically demanding of any living highland fiber art across Southeast Asia; the Flower Hmong, one of over 60 Hmong sub-groups distributed across Vietnam, Laos, Thailand, and China, take their common name from this textile, and a woman's skill as an embroiderer remains among the most significant social credentials of her community. The Ndebele woman from the Mpumalanga and Limpopo provinces of South Africa stands in her idzila - the columns of stacked beaded neck rings in vivid geometric bands of red, yellow, blue, and green that rise from shoulder to jaw and are begun in childhood, enlarged gradually, and never removed after marriage; among the approximately 750,000 Ndebele speakers of southern Africa the idzila encodes family lineage and marital status in a color grammar that is specific down to the individual household, and the geometric precision of Ndebele beadwork and mural painting has been recognized as a distinct

and highly influential visual language, its patterns appearing in the work of designers and architects internationally since the 1980s without credit. The Yoruba woman from the cities and towns of southwestern Nigeria stands beneath her gele - the elaborately folded and constructed head wrap whose architectural peaks and fans a skilled tier can raise forty centimeters above the head, the fabric in deep gold-copper aso-oke woven on narrow strip looms in the specific color that signals celebration; among more than 40 million Yoruba speakers the gele is not everyday clothing but event architecture, a headpiece that makes the wearer's arrival in any room an event, and its forms are as precisely codified by occasion as any ceremonial dress tradition in the world, its diaspora presence in Cuban Lucumi and Brazilian Candomble ceremonies having carried it to two other continents where it remains in active use.

Tortilla Human (2023)

Technique: Tortilla dough, armature structure, life-size figurative sculpture

Display: Gallery floor installation, climate-sensitive display

A life-sized human figure sculpted entirely from tortilla dough.

Masa is not a metaphor. It is the actual substance from which millions of human beings in this region have been built, fed, sustained. Cienfuegos Mora takes this literalness — which is already present in pre-Hispanic creation mythology — and makes it visible at human scale. The figure deteriorates depending on humidity and temperature. It is not preserved. The impermanence is the point. The piece was made from corn and will return to corn or mold or both. Whether you find this moving or disgusting probably says something about your relationship to your food.

Brother Anselm Kessler

Former medieval manuscript scholar turned contemporary artist, Kessler creates detailed mystical diagrams that blend ancient spiritual cartography with Hindu philosophy and invented linguistic systems. Working from a converted monastery in Bavaria, his practice resurrects the lost art of sacred infographics through the lens of Tantric psychology and medieval mysticism.

Brother Anselm Kessler spent two decades studying illuminated manuscripts at the Vatican Library before discovering the works of Sir Edward Woodroffe and ancient Hindu texts on the psychology of mind, body, and the interconnecting subtle layers of existence. This encounter with Tantric philosophy and Sanskrit treatises on disembodied entities revolutionized his understanding of medieval mysticism — he realized that both traditions were mapping the same territories using different cartographic languages. Working in oil with the precision of a medieval scribe but informed by Hindu concepts of chakras, koshas, and the subtle body, Kessler develops detailed diagrams that synthesize Christian angelology with Hindu psychology of consciousness. His paintings treat the afterlife not as destination but as navigable territory populated by various classes of disembodied entities. Every piece is annotated in an invented script that borrows from both Latin theological notation and Sanskrit mystical terminology. His work occupies the space between East and West, between medieval manuscript and ancient Hindu manual, creating instruction guides for territories that both traditions describe but neither fully maps. Critics have called his practice 'rigorously syncretic' and 'convincingly universal,' terms he considers complementary rather than contradictory.

Series: Sacred Mechanics

Soul Energy Flow Diagram (2024)

Technique: Oil painting on canvas, invented script annotation, medieval manuscript style

Display: Gallery wall, requires close viewing for detail appreciation

A detailed diagram mapping the flow of positive and negative spiritual energy through the human soul, annotated entirely in an invented mystical language.

Kessler's most foundational piece treats the soul as a hydraulic system, complete with flow charts, directional arrows, and pressure indicators. Positive microvita (rendered as luminous geometric forms) and negative microvita (depicted as shadowy angular shapes) move through carefully mapped spiritual channels. The diagram suggests that enlightenment is a matter of proper spiritual plumbing — redirect the flow here, increase pressure there, and transcendence becomes as achievable as assembling

furniture. The invented script annotations provide detailed instructions that sound authoritative and feel ancient, despite being completely fabricated. Viewers often find themselves convinced they're looking at genuine esoteric knowledge, which is precisely Kessler's point: the line between authentic spiritual wisdom and convincing spiritual theater is thinner than most people would like to admit.

Angelic Hierarchy Navigation Chart (2024)

Technique: Oil painting on canvas, gold leaf details, invented theological notation

Display: Gallery wall installation, corporate-scale presentation

An organizational chart depicting the complete hierarchy of angels from Seraphim to guardian angels, with detailed reporting structures and jurisdictional boundaries.

Working from medieval angelology and corporate org charts in equal measure, Kessler presents the celestial bureaucracy as a comprehensible management structure. Seraphim occupy the C-suite level, Cherubim handle middle management, and various orders of angels fill specialized departments: Communications (Archangels), Human Resources (Guardian Angels), and Enforcement (Powers). Each angelic rank is illustrated with appropriate iconography and connected by precise hierarchical lines. The invented annotations explain reporting structures, vacation policies, and jurisdictional disputes. The piece asks whether heaven operates more like a spiritual realm or a very well-organized corporation, and suggests the distinction might be less clear than we'd prefer.

Demonic Classification System (2025)

Technique: Oil painting on canvas, dark pigments, taxonomical illustration style

Display: Gallery wall, natural history museum aesthetic

A scientific taxonomy of demons organized by function, habitat, and specialized skills, presented in the style of a medieval bestiary meets biological field guide.

Kessler approaches demonology with the rigor of a field biologist, creating detailed taxonomical classifications for various orders of demons. Each demonic type is illustrated with careful attention to distinguishing

characteristics: horn configurations, wing patterns, preferred habitats, and specialized functions in the spiritual ecosystem. The invented script provides species names, behavioral notes, and identification keys. Demons are organized into logical categories: Administrative (paperwork delays, bureaucratic confusion), Domestic (missing socks, burnt toast), and Existential (Sunday evening dread, career anxiety). The piece treats evil as a natural phenomenon requiring proper scientific classification rather than moral judgment, which somehow makes it both more rational and more unsettling.

Spiritual Anatomy Atlas (2024)

Technique: Oil painting on canvas, anatomical precision, layered spiritual systems

Display: Gallery wall, medical illustration aesthetic

A detailed anatomical chart showing the location and function of spiritual organs within the human body: the soul's liver, the heart's prayer chambers, the mind's divine reception antenna.

In Kessler's most ambitious piece, the human body becomes a complex spiritual machine with identifiable spiritual organs. The soul's liver processes karmic toxins. The heart contains specialized prayer chambers for different types of divine communication. The brain features a divine reception antenna that can be tuned to various celestial frequencies. Each spiritual organ is painted with anatomical precision and labeled with invented terminology that sounds both ancient and medical. The piece suggests that spiritual health operates according to the same principles as physical health — regular maintenance, proper diet, and periodic diagnostic check-ups. It's a medical manual for the soul, complete with troubleshooting guide.

Diego Xólotl Hernández

Guadalajara-born painter working in Mexico City, Hernández creates monumental oil paintings that merge pre-Columbian mythology with contemporary industrial imagery. His large-scale canvases explore the collision between ancient creation myths and modern Mexican identity.

Diego Xólotl Hernández (named after the Aztec god of lightning and death) approaches painting as a form of mythological archaeology. His canvases, some reaching 4 by 6 meters, function as visual novels where Mesoamerican creation stories collide with the realities of modern Mexico. Trained in traditional oil painting techniques in Guadalajara and later influenced by muralists like Orozco and Rivera, Hernández develops a hyperrealistic style that treats mythology as documentary fact. His work asks what creation myths would look like if they were happening now, in factories and city streets, with the same gods but different materials. Critics have described his paintings as 'industrial mythology' and 'sacred capitalism rendered visible.' Each canvas takes months to complete, every detail meticulously painted as if witnessing actual divine events unfolding in contemporary Mexico.

Series: Mythological Realism

Corn Man Genesis (2024)

Technique: Oil painting on large format canvas, photorealistic detail

Display: Museum wall, requires substantial space for viewing distance

A monumental painting depicting a human figure assembled grain by grain from individual corn kernels, rendering the Popol Vuh creation myth in obsessive photorealistic detail.

Hernández treats the Mayan creation story from the Popol Vuh not as metaphor but as reportage. His 3 by 4 meter canvas shows a human figure constructed entirely from individually painted corn kernels, each one catching light differently, some golden, some white, some deep orange-red. The figure appears to be awakening, emerging from a scattered field of loose corn that gradually organizes itself into human form. Every grain is painted with the precision of a 17th-century Dutch still life, yet the overall composition reads as contemporary photorealism. The background shows the misty mountains of Guatemala where the myth originates, but painted with such hyperreal detail that they seem more real than reality. Hernández spends months on each kernel, treating the creation of the first humans as an event worthy of the most obsessive documentation.

Maseca Factory of the Gods (2024)

Technique: Oil painting on large format canvas, industrial and mythological imagery

Display: Large gallery wall or museum space, industrial-scale presentation

A deity that is half ancient Coatlicue and half industrial assembly machinery operates a modern masa factory producing human figures instead of tortillas.

In Hernández's most ambitious composition, the Aztec mother goddess Coatlicue has been partially mechanized, her lower half replaced by industrial masa-processing equipment. She operates a vast factory where conveyor belts carry tortilla dough that transforms into human figures as it moves through the production line. Her serpent skirt becomes industrial tubing, her necklace of hands and hearts now feeds the machinery with raw materials. Workers in Maseca uniforms tend to the production of humanity itself, quality-checking the emerging people for defects. Steam rises from the industrial equipment, but it's perfumed with copal incense. The factory floor is both sacred space and industrial site. Hernández paints every detail with documentary precision: the brand logos, the safety equipment, the divine necklaces, the emerging humans blinking in the fluorescent light of their birthplace.

Cosmic Punk Tezcatlipoca (2025)

Technique: Oil painting on large format canvas, cosmic and street imagery

Display: Gallery wall with dark lighting to enhance cosmic elements

A figure that embodies both Aztec god Tezcatlipoca and contemporary Mexican punk culture, draped in material that is simultaneously a sarape and the Milky Way galaxy. Tezcatlipunk

Hernández's most conceptually ambitious piece depicts a figure that refuses to choose between ancient divinity and contemporary street culture. The central character sports a mohawk that trails into obsidian smoke, facial piercings that catch starlight, and leather jacket sleeves that seamlessly transform into jaguar fur. The sarape draped across the figure's shoulders is painted as the actual Milky Way — every star individually rendered — while maintaining the traditional patterns and colors of Mexican textile work. The figure stands in what appears to be both a urban

alleyway covered in graffiti and the cosmic void between worlds. Band patches on the jacket read names of Aztec deities in punk typography. The painting asks whether rebellion is always sacred, whether the gods would be punks if they walked among us now, and whether the cosmos and the street corner are really such different territories.

Marcus Delacroix

Paris-trained conceptual artist of French-Mexican heritage who mostly paints on human body-shaped canvases, exploring the tension between the universal human form and infinite artistic possibilities. Based between Lyon and Montreal, his practice investigates the body as both boundary and container.

Marcus Delacroix's obsession with the human silhouette began not from anatomical study but from a simple conceptual question: what happens when you constrain infinite artistic possibility within the outline of a single form? Born to a French father and Mexican mother, his dual heritage informs his understanding of how identity shapes within boundaries. Every canvas in his studio is cut to the exact proportions of a standing human figure, but what fills these silhouettes ranges from pure abstraction to detailed landscapes to conceptual installations. Delacroix treats the human outline as both limitation and liberation — a formal constraint that paradoxically opens up new creative territories. His work asks whether the human form is a cage for artistic content or a key that unlocks it. Critics have described his practice as 'rigorously constrained' and 'unexpectedly expansive,' terms he considers complementary rather than contradictory. The body, for Delacroix, is not subject matter but sculptural problem: how do you fill the shape of a person with everything that person is not?

Series: Corporeal Cartographies

Art History Body (2024)

Technique: Mixed media painting on body-shaped canvas, multiple historical styles applied zone by zone

Display: Gallery wall installation, large-format wall-hanging body-shaped canvas

A human body-shaped canvas where each body part is rendered in a different historical or contemporary art style, from cave painting hands to pixelated genitalia to Renaissance anatomy.

This piece functions as both art historical survey and anatomical joke, and somehow succeeds at being both. Delacroix divides the human silhouette into zones, each rendered in a different artistic tradition: the left hand emerges from Lascaux, the torso channels Caravaggio, one eye goes full manga while the other remains photographic. The heart appears as a contemporary medical diagram while the feet sport Renaissance drapery and modern sneakers. What could have been mere pastiche becomes something stranger — a body that contains all of art history, or an art history that can only be understood through the human form. The piece suggests that every artistic movement has been, fundamentally, an attempt to figure out what a person looks like.

Landscape Body (2023)

Technique: Oil painting on body-shaped canvas, photorealistic landscape rendering

Display: Gallery wall installation, natural lighting preferred

A human silhouette entirely painted as a continuous mountain landscape, with the head as snow-capped peaks and the torso as rolling valleys.

Delacroix transforms the human figure into topography, painting a seamless mountain landscape that follows the contours of the body-shaped canvas. The head becomes snow-capped peaks catching golden light, the shoulders roll into foothills, the torso opens into a green valley with a winding river that follows the spine. The legs descend into darker, forested slopes that disappear into mist. The piece asks whether we see landscape in the human form or human form in landscape, and suggests that perhaps the distinction is less important than the recognition. Viewers often report seeing both simultaneously — a body that is also a mountain range, a mountain range that is also a body.

Abstract Expressionist Body (2024)

Technique: Acrylic and oil painting on body-shaped canvas, gestural abstraction

Display: Gallery wall installation, high-contrast lighting

A human silhouette painted in pure abstract expressionist style, with violent gestural brushstrokes and color fields that completely dissolve the figurative reference.

Here Delacroix pushes against his own formal constraint. The body-shaped canvas is painted in aggressive abstract expressionist gestures — thick impasto, violent color relationships, brushstrokes that seem to want to escape the human outline entirely. The piece becomes a tension between container and content: the human form trying to hold pure abstraction, abstraction trying to break free from figuration. The result is neither purely abstract nor purely figurative, but something caught between states. Delacroix calls it 'the body's resistance to becoming pure feeling' — whether that's the body resisting or the feeling resisting is deliberately unclear.

Constellation Body (2025)

Technique: Oil painting and embedded LED lights on body-shaped canvas, astronomical mapping

Display: Darkened gallery room, interactive star chart reference available

A human silhouette painted as deep space with embedded LED points representing actual star positions, turning the body into a navigable star chart.

Delacroix collaborates with astronomers to create a precise star map using the human form as coordinate system. The body-shaped canvas is painted as deep space — rich blues and blacks with subtle nebula formations — and embedded with hundreds of tiny LED lights positioned to match actual stellar coordinates. The head contains the North Star and surrounding constellations, the torso maps the celestial equator, the limbs extend into the zodiac. Viewers can navigate by the body, using anatomical landmarks to find Polaris or trace the path of Mars. The piece suggests that we have always used our bodies to understand space, and that space, in return, helps us understand our bodies.

Still Life Body (2023)

Technique: Oil painting on body-shaped canvas, Dutch Golden Age still life technique

Display: Gallery wall installation, warm traditional lighting

A human silhouette painted as an elaborate still life arrangement, with the head as fruit bowl and the torso containing flowers, books, and luxury objects in classical Dutch style.

Working in the precise technique of 17th-century Dutch masters, Delacroix transforms the human figure into an elaborate still life composition. The head becomes a overflowing fruit bowl with perfect apple highlights and grape translucency. The torso contains an arrangement of tulips, leather-bound books, a skull, silver vessels, and draped fabric — all the symbolic elements of vanitas paintings. The arms extend into wine bottles and bread loaves. The piece operates on multiple levels of mortality: the still life tradition's meditation on death, the body as memento mori, and the preservation of both through paint. It's simultaneously the most alive and most dead thing in Delacroix's practice.

Happy Family (2025)

Technique: Oil painting on multiple body-shaped canvases, coordinated landscape composition

Display: Gallery installation with precise positioning requirements, family arrangement

Four human body-shaped canvases (mother, father, child, and dog) each painted with portions of the same continuous mountain landscape, positioned to complete the scene when viewed together.

Delacroix's most ambitious compositional experiment treats the family unit as a fragmented landscape viewer. Four body-shaped canvases — scaled for mother, father, child, and family dog — each contain precisely positioned portions of the same mountain vista. When arranged in correct gallery positions, the bodies serve as windows or masks revealing different sections of one continuous landscape: the mother's silhouette might contain the left mountain range, the father's the central valley, the child's the right peaks, and the dog's the foreground meadow. The piece asks whether families see the same world or whether each member glimpses

only fragments, and whether those fragments can ever be reassembled into a coherent whole. Viewers experience both the unity of the landscape and the separation of the figures simultaneously — a meditation on togetherness and isolation rendered in oil and human outline.

French Cuisine (2024)

Technique: Oil painting on body-shaped canvas, hyperrealistic food rendering

Display: Gallery wall installation, warm lighting to enhance food textures

A human silhouette painted as an elaborate arrangement of classic French cuisine, with the head as a wheel of Camembert and the torso containing coq au vin, fresh baguettes, and wine bottles.

Delacroix's homage to his French heritage transforms the human figure into a curated selection from a Parisian bistro menu. The head becomes a perfectly aged wheel of Camembert, its creamy interior visible through realistic cross-section. The neck flows into a wine bottle, the torso contains an arrangement of coq au vin with visible chicken pieces and rich burgundy sauce, while the arms extend into fresh baguettes with realistic flour dusting. The legs contain escargot shells, macarons, and a selection of French cheeses. Every item is painted with the precision of a still life master, yet the overall composition maintains the unmistakable silhouette of a standing figure. The piece asks whether cultural identity is something we consume or something that consumes us, while celebrating the sensual pleasure of both food and form.

Mexican Mercado (2025)

Technique: Oil painting on body-shaped canvas, vibrant market imagery

Display: Gallery wall installation, vibrant market-style lighting

A human silhouette painted as a Mexican market spread, with the head as a stack of fresh tortillas and the body containing mole poblano, chiles en nogada, fresh avocados, and traditional sweets.

Drawing from his mother's Mexican heritage, Delacroix fills the human form with the abundance of a traditional mercado. The head becomes a stack of warm corn tortillas, steam visible between layers. The torso contains a rich mole poblano with its complex sauce visible in cross-section, while chiles en nogada provide patriotic red, white, and green

coloring across the chest. The arms extend into fresh avocados and bundles of epazote, the legs contain traditional dulces like cocada and camote. Marigold flowers (cempasúcil) frame the entire figure, referencing Day of the Dead traditions. The painting treats Mexican cuisine not as exotic other but as maternal inheritance, every dish painted with the familiarity of childhood memory rather than tourist curiosity. It's Delacroix's most personal piece, where the constraint of the human form becomes a vessel for cultural belonging.

Evolutionary Body (2025)

Technique: Oil painting on body-shaped canvas, scientific illustration precision

Display: Natural history museum or science gallery wall, educational lighting

A human silhouette depicting evolutionary hierarchy, with primates in the head, a human figure in the pituitary gland, descending through mammals, reptiles, insects, and microorganisms toward the feet.

Delacroix's most scientifically ambitious piece treats the human form as a taxonomical chart of life itself. The head contains various primate species — gorillas, chimpanzees, orangutans — while a tiny human figure occupies the pituitary gland, suggesting our place in the hierarchy of consciousness. The torso descends through evolutionary time: mammals in the chest (lions, wolves, horses), reptiles in the abdomen (snakes, lizards, ancient dinosaurs), amphibians at the waist. The legs contain insects painted with entomological precision — beetles, ants, butterflies — while the feet dissolve into microscopic organisms: bacteria, protozoans, and viruses rendered visible only through Delacroix's magnifying artistic lens. The piece asks whether humans are the culmination of evolution or simply another temporary arrangement of life, while celebrating the stunning diversity that the human outline can contain.

Pierre-Luc Beaumont

Montreal-born, Berlin-based conceptual artist whose work disassembles consumer products, cultural totems, and masterpieces alike with equal parts precision and irreverence.

Pierre-Luc Beaumont comes from a family of butchers and a university education in philosophy, a combination that explains both the clinical rigor of his deconstructions and the slight air of menace that surrounds them. He does not destroy things so much as reveal what they were always composed of. The Mona Lisa is pigment and oil. A hotdog is a pig and corn syrup and a tube. A car is bags of plastic and planks of steel. Beaumont does not find this depressing. He finds it extremely funny, and occasionally sublime.

Series: Material Confessions

Deconstructed Paintings (2022)

Technique: Pigment extraction, chemical analysis, laboratory glassware, museum vitrines

Display: Museum vitrine display, clinical laboratory aesthetic

The exact amounts and pigments used to create canonical paintings — the Mona Lisa, Guernica, Rothko canvases — displayed as color-separated residue in laboratory test tubes.

Da Vinci's sfumato becomes a faint smear of lead white and smalt in a glass tube. Guernica becomes charcoal and ivory black in measured grams. Rothko — generous, atmospheric Rothko — becomes surprisingly little pigment for such immense emotional territory. Beaumont's gesture strips painting of its mystique without diminishing it, which should not be possible, and yet somehow is. What remains after you remove the brush, the hand, the intention, and the centuries of interpretation is, apparently, just chemistry. And chemistry turns out to be beautiful. Variants: El Guernica (black, white, grey), Rothko (minimal residue), Mona Lisa (Renaissance ground pigments).

Hotdog (2022)

Technique: Sculptural installation, food ingredient display, industrial components

Display: Gallery installation with sculptural centerpiece and ingredient displays

All the ingredients of a hotdog — including a sculptural pig — displayed together as a deconstructed whole, from meat source to bread flour to every additive.

Beaumont's most comprehensive deconstruction treats the humble hotdog as an industrial archaeology project. A life-sized pig sculpture anchors the installation, surrounded by the full spectrum of hotdog components: wheat flour and yeast for the buns, tomatoes for ketchup, cucumbers for pickles, mustard seeds, corn syrup, sodium nitrates, natural casings, paprika, garlic powder, and a dozen other preservatives and flavor enhancers, each in its own labeled container. The piece reveals the hotdog as a complex industrial achievement involving multiple agricultural systems, chemical processes, and global supply chains. What appears simple becomes dizzyingly complex when fully deconstructed. Beaumont treats this revelation not as criticism but as wonder — the hotdog as monument to human ingenuity and appetite.

Raw Material Car (2023)

Technique: Industrial deconstruction, raw material display, factory floor aesthetic

Display: Large gallery space or industrial museum floor installation

A car fully deconstructed into its raw materials: planks of steel, bags of plastic, PCB boards, bags of integrated circuits, coiled copper.

There is a specific weight to this piece that photographs cannot capture. A car is heavy. Its raw materials are heavier, somehow, in their honesty. The steel planks that will become a door panel, the small bag of silicon that will become a processor, the coiled copper that will become wiring — displayed without their function, they lose the language that makes them invisible in the finished object. Beaumont's car is more car than a car. It tells you everything about what you are driving and absolutely nothing about where you are going.

Transcendental (2023)

Technique: McDonald's hamburger, vacuum chamber, acrylic display casing, white pedestal

Display: Gallery pedestal, white cube space

A McDonald's hamburger displayed inside a vacuum chamber.

Beaumont has described this piece as his most sincere. The hamburger does not decompose in a vacuum — it simply exists, suspended, neither dead nor alive in the usual biological sense. The vacuum chamber is laboratory-grade, transparent, mounted on a white pedestal. Visitors are invited to contemplate a Big Mac stripped of oxygen, stripped of context, stripped of the possibility of being eaten. In the absence of biological process, it achieves a kind of permanence. This is either a commentary on industrial food production, a meditation on preservation, or the most expensive hamburger not to be eaten in contemporary art history.

Keiko Tanaka-Morales

Japanese-Mexican conceptual artist based in Tokyo who laser-engraves sacred symbols from multiple spiritual traditions onto mass-produced snack foods, exploring the collision between ancient wisdom and contemporary consumer culture.

Keiko Tanaka-Morales grew up between two worlds: her Japanese grandmother's Buddhist meditation practice and her Mexican grandfather's Day of the Dead altars, both existing within the hypermodern consumer landscape of Tokyo. This cultural trilingualism — East Asian spirituality, Mesoamerican mysticism, and global capitalism — defines her artistic practice. Working with industrial laser engravers typically used for manufacturing, she inscribes sacred geometries, religious iconography, and spiritual symbols onto mass-produced snack foods with mechanical precision. Each piece begins with extensive research into the historical and cultural significance of the symbols, followed by equally rigorous attention to the material properties of the chosen snack food substrate. The Pringle's hyperbolic paraboloid surface, the Cheeto's irregular organic form, the street potato's rough texture — each presents specific technical and conceptual challenges. Tanaka-Morales treats these interventions not

as desecration but as democratization: making sacred imagery accessible through the most common objects in contemporary life. Her practice asks whether spiritual symbols lose or gain power when inscribed on disposable consumer goods, and whether the sacred can survive translation into the language of global capitalism.

Series: Sacred Snacks

Coatlicue Papas (2022)

Technique: Laser engraving on street potato chips, museum vitrine display

Display: Museum vitrine series, individual chip displays

The Aztec goddess Coatlicue laser-engraved onto Mexican street potato chips, preserving both the sacred imagery and the ephemeral snack food in gallery vitrines.

Tanaka-Morales sources authentic papas de calle from Mexico City street vendors, then uses precision laser engraving to inscribe detailed images of Coatlicue — the Aztec mother goddess of earth and death — onto their irregular surfaces. Each potato chip becomes a canvas for pre-Columbian iconography, the rough texture creating shadows that enhance the goddess's fearsome complexity. The pieces are preserved in individual museum vitrines, treating street snacks with the reverence typically reserved for archaeological artifacts. The work functions as homecoming and displacement simultaneously: Coatlicue returns to Mexican territory but on the most disposable of contemporary Mexican foods. The goddess of death rendered on food that will itself decay creates a meditation on impermanence that operates across both spiritual and material registers.

Enso Pringles (2022)

Technique: Single-stroke laser engraving on Pringles, traditional Japanese mounting

Display: Traditional Japanese scroll mounting, gallery wall series

Perfect enso circles laser-engraved onto Pringles in single continuous motions, each chip mounted with traditional Japanese hanging scroll aesthetics.

The enso — the Zen circle drawn in a single breath to represent enlightenment, strength, and the void — requires complete presence and cannot be corrected once begun. Tanaka-Morales adapts this ancient practice to industrial precision, programming laser engravers to complete each circle in one unbroken motion across the Pringle's curved surface. The hyperbolic paraboloid shape of the chip creates subtle distortions that make each enso unique despite mechanical reproduction. Some circles are perfect, others intentionally incomplete, following traditional enso variations. Each chip is mounted using traditional Japanese scroll techniques — fine wood backing, silk threads, proper spacing — treating the mass-produced snack with the ceremonial respect of calligraphy masters. The series asks whether mechanical reproduction can achieve the spiritual presence of hand-drawing, and whether the Zen void can be contained within consumer culture's most precise geometries.

Rising Sun Cheetos (2022)

Technique: Laser engraving on Cheetos, color-matched mounting system

Display: Color-coordinated mounting, wall installation series

Japanese Rising Sun motifs laser-engraved onto orange Cheetos, with the snack food's natural color perfectly matching traditional red-orange sun imagery.

The accident of color harmony becomes the foundation of intentional art. Tanaka-Morales discovers that Cheetos' artificial orange matches almost exactly the traditional red-orange of Japanese Rising Sun imagery, creating an unexpected aesthetic unity between consumer product and national symbol. Using laser engraving, she inscribes radiating sun patterns onto the irregular surfaces of individual Cheetos, each snack food's unique organic form creating variations in the traditional geometric pattern. The pieces are mounted to emphasize the color relationship — some against white backgrounds to make the orange pop, others against gradients that move from orange to deep red. The work operates in multiple registers simultaneously: as cultural collision, as found color theory, and as meditation on how consumer culture accidentally reproduces traditional aesthetics. The Rising Sun's historical complexity as both spiritual symbol and imperial emblem adds political layers to what begins as pure visual coincidence.

Pringles Mandala (2023)

Technique: Laser engraving on Pringles chips, Tibetan-style mounting

Display: Tibetan-inspired mounting, individual chip displays

Traditional Tibetan sand mandala patterns laser-engraved onto Pringles chips, taking advantage of their mathematically precise hyperbolic paraboloid surface.

Drawing from her study of Tibetan Buddhist sand mandalas, Tanaka-Morales uses the Pringle's mathematically precise hyperbolic paraboloid surface as the ideal canvas for traditional mandala geometry. The chip's uniform curvature allows for perfect symmetrical patterns that would be impossible on irregular surfaces. Each Pringle receives a complete mandala design, the geometric patterns following the mathematical curves of the chip's engineered shape. The laser engraving creates subtle depth variations that enhance the mandala's traditional dimensionality. Where sand mandalas are destroyed upon completion to demonstrate impermanence, these chip mandalas achieve a different kind of transience — they could theoretically be eaten, though they're preserved in gallery conditions. The work explores whether industrial food design can accidentally create the perfect substrate for sacred geometry.

Kettle Chip Mandala (2023)

Technique: Laser engraving on kettle-cooked potato chips, adaptive pattern recognition

Display: Individual chip displays emphasizing surface variation

Tibetan mandala patterns laser-engraved onto irregular kettle chips, with each pattern adapted to the unique topography of individual chips.

The kettle chip's irregular topography — ridges, valleys, and bubbled surfaces created during high-temperature cooking — presents the opposite challenge of the uniform Pringle. Tanaka-Morales develops adaptive laser engraving programs that read each chip's individual surface and modify traditional mandala patterns to follow the organic landscape. No two pieces are identical; each mandala bends and flows with the chip's unique geology. The result transforms industrial food irregularities into spiritual variations, suggesting that imperfection and sacred geometry can coexist. The rough texture creates dramatic shadows that change as

viewing angle shifts, making the mandala appear to move and breathe. This adaptation of fixed geometric patterns to organic surfaces mirrors Buddhism's teaching about adapting eternal truths to changing circumstances.

Rice Cracker Mandala (2023)

Technique: Laser engraving on rice crackers, ultra-fine detail work

Display: Specialized lighting to reveal subtle engravings, protective display

Extremely detailed Tibetan mandala patterns laser-engraved onto delicate rice crackers, pushing the limits of both material fragility and engraving precision.

The rice cracker — thin, delicate, prone to cracking — demands the most precise laser calibration in Tanaka-Morales' practice. Working at the absolute minimum power settings, she engraves complete mandala patterns onto these fragile substrates, each piece requiring perfect technical execution to avoid destroying the cracker entirely. The rice cracker's pale surface and fine grain create the most subtle visual effects, with mandala patterns appearing almost like shadows or watermarks. Some pieces crack during the process, which Tanaka-Morales preserves as meditation on fragility and impermanence — the mandala literally broken by the process of its creation. The successful pieces achieve an almost ghostly delicacy, suggesting that the most profound spiritual expressions might require the most vulnerable materials.

Xochipilli Tostadas (2022)

Technique: Laser engraving on tostadas, transparent resin casting, gallery vitrine

Display: Museum vitrine display, individual resin blocks

Detailed images of Xochipilli, the Aztec god of art and flowers, laser-engraved onto corn tostadas and preserved in transparent resin blocks.

Tanaka-Morales treats the corn tostada as the perfect substrate for pre-Columbian iconography — corn being the foundational grain of Mesoamerican civilization and Xochipilli being the patron deity of art, music, poetry, and psychoactive plants. Each tostada receives a detailed laser engraving of the flower god, his elaborate headdress and ornate body decorations rendered with mechanical precision onto the golden

corn surface. The completed pieces are then encased in crystal-clear resin blocks, preserving both the ancient imagery and the ephemeral snack food for eternity. The resin creates a lens effect that magnifies the laser-engraved details while simultaneously commenting on preservation, consumer culture, and the transformation of sacred imagery. The god of flowers suspended in petroleum-based resin becomes a meditation on how indigenous culture survives within contemporary materials, neither fully preserved nor completely transformed.

Oluwafemi Okonkwo

Lagos-born and working between Dakar and Sao Paulo, Okonkwo makes large-scale kinetic paint installations that treat color as elemental force — recyclable, inexhaustible, and in need of no justification.

Okonkwo spent ten years working in industrial paint factories before attending art school, and the experience shows. He has a precise understanding of viscosity, pigment density, and flow dynamics that most painters spend their entire careers approximating. What he does with this knowledge is less industrial than ceremonial: fountains of color that never stop, recycled and recirculated, separated by density or gravity, returned to source. His work is generous in scale and in scale alone — it does not argue with you. It simply pours.

Series: Chromatic Liturgy

Primary Colors (2022)

Technique: IBC industrial tanks, silver chrome metal frame, industrial pigment

Display: Outdoor industrial space, factory courtyard, or large gallery warehouse

Silver-chromed IBC tanks stacked vertically: red at the base, blue in the middle, yellow at the top.

The IBC tank — that squat, practical, globally ubiquitous container of industrial fluids — becomes, in Okonkwo's hands, a monument. Stacked

three high and chrome-finished, they arrange the primary colors in a vertical sequence that reads simultaneously as a color theory diagram, a corporate logo, and a pagan totem. The material is blunt. The gesture is blunt. The effect, in person, is unexpectedly moving. There is something about the scale of industrial containers filled with pure pigment that refuses to be ironic.

Purple (2022)

Technique: IBC industrial tanks, gold chrome metal frame, purple industrial pigment

Display: Outdoor or large indoor industrial space, companion to Primary Colors

Gold-chromed IBC tanks stacked with deep purple pigment — a regal variant of the primary color tank series.

Where the Primary Colors series announces itself as a lesson, Purple refuses the pedagogy. Purple is singular, excessive, associated with wealth, mourning, and bruising in equal measure. Okonkwo's gold-chromed frame elevates it further — a monument to a color that has always been about elevation. The IBC tank, instrument of global supply chains, becomes a reliquary. The pigment inside costs approximately fourteen euros per liter. This is mentioned in the exhibition notes.

Fountain I, II, III (2023)

Technique: Engineered fountain mechanism, oil-based paint, color separation and closed-loop recycling system

Display: Gallery floor installation or outdoor plaza, functioning fountain scale

Three traditionally shaped fountains pour separated paint colors continuously — primary colors, pastels, and a punk palette — with all paint recycled in a closed loop.

Duchamp's Fountain was a urinal. Okonkwo's Fountains actually flow. Three versions: primary colors, pastel shades, and an aggressive punk palette of bright green, electric blue, and yellow. The paint never stops. It never dries — the chemistry has been carefully managed. It recycles. The fountain form — civic, classical, associated with public pleasure —

becomes a delivery mechanism for chromatic excess. You could, technically, drink from these. Okonkwo does not recommend it.

Spray Paint Series (2023)

Technique: Mechanized spray cans, closed-loop paint recycling system, rotating sculpture armature

Display: Gallery warehouse, multiple sub-installations within single space

Mechanically powered spray cans continuously pour paint over sculptures and walls, then the paint is separated and recycled. A rotating formally-dressed man, a wall receiving black and gold, pastel pink and green, and orange and red variants.

The spray can is the tool of the unauthorized, the nocturnal, the urgent. Okonkwo mechanizes it, domesticates it, makes it run on schedule with a timer and a recycling pump. The results are perversely beautiful: a formally dressed man rotates slowly under streams of pink, deep blue, and purple; black and gold drown a wall and drain away; pastel pink and green bleed together then separate. The machine does not get tired. The paint does not run out. The colors multiply. The wall is always fresh. Productivity has never looked so magnificent.

River of Change (2024)

Technique: Hydrographic pigment on flowing water surface, rotating canvas, continuous pigment feed, 10-meter bath

Display: Large studio or gallery with elongated floor footprint

An immensely long hydrographic painting created by progressively adding and morphing pigment patterns on a flowing water surface, absorbed continuously by a rotating canvas.

Hydrographic printing — the industrial process for applying patterns to curved surfaces — is normally used on gun grips and motorcycle helmets. Okonkwo adapts it to a ten-meter continuous canvas. Pigment flows. Patterns form and dissolve. The canvas rotates, absorbing the surface as it moves. The resulting work is never the same twice and always legible as a record of its own making. There are moments in the process where the flowing pigment produces images that look deliberately composed, which

is either coincidence or evidence of something that cannot quite be named. Okonkwo says it is coincidence. He says it every time.

Golden Rain Sculptures (2024)

Technique: Thick golden pigment medium, recirculating pump, white plaster sculptures, continuous flow installation

Display: Gallery installation, sculptures on plinths with recirculating drainage trays

Streams of thick golden pigment pour continuously from above onto white sculptures — a plain man's bust, a family group, a seated man, a thin Buddha — engineered not to stick.

The gold flows and does not stop. The medium is engineered so the pigment beads and runs without coating — always gilding, never gilded. The sculptures remain white beneath the perpetual anointing. This is the theological crux: the grace arrives continuously and leaves no permanent mark. The family group — each member absorbed in their separate activity, each receiving their own golden stream — is the most unsettling of the four variants. They do not look up.

Real Skull Fountain (2024)

Technique: Real or high-quality replica skull, plumbing integration, blue, pink, and white liquid

Display: Gallery pedestal, secured installation, viewer distance maintained

A fountain made from a real skull with streams of blue, pink, and white liquid flowing from it continuously.

This is the piece that gets Okonkwo's exhibition permits pulled. The skull is the oldest symbol of mortality we have, and Okonkwo makes it function. It flows. Blue, pink, white — colors that belong in a nursery or a pool party, not in a skull. The combination refuses the dignity that skulls usually demand. It is both more disturbing than a solemn memento mori and, in a perverse way, more true to life: we are, in the end, structures through which color passes.

Paint Fountains Full Wall (2023)

Technique: Large-scale wall installation, paint circulation system, floor-to-ceiling color cascade

Display: Large gallery or museum, full wall architectural installation

Paint fountains scaled to cover entire gallery walls in flowing, recycled streams of color from ceiling to floor.

The wall format removes the civic reference of the fountain basin and replaces it with something architectural — closer to waterfall, closer to the sublime. The paint flows floor to ceiling across the full wall span, recycled in a sealed system visible behind the piece. In full-wall format, the colors begin to feel less decorative and more atmospheric. You are not looking at paint. You are standing inside a field of color that happens to be moving. The distinction between pigment and environment quietly disappears.

Alejandro Camus

Born in Tlaxcala, Mexico, and working between Copenhagen and Mexico City, Camus makes installations and sculptures that sit at the intersection of spiritual inquiry, material science, and the long detour a life can take before it finds its form.

Alejandro Camus did not arrive at art directly. He grew up in Tlaxcala, a state so old its name predates the Aztec empire, and left as a young man with a guitar. He spent years as a street musician — in Mexico City, in Oaxaca, in places that were not paying attention — before the itinerant life led him to farming and then to a spiritual ecovillage in the Mexican highlands where he stayed for several years, working land and attending to silence. He then moved to a second ecovillage in Denmark, where the silence had a different texture and the winters required a different vocabulary. From there he studied software engineering, which he found was simply another way of asking how systems hold together and what happens when they fail. He opened a coffee shop in Copenhagen, which he describes as the most spiritual thing he has ever done and which lasted several years before he understood that what he was actually doing was preparing an installation: a room in which strangers come to be warm, pay a small amount for it, and leave. The transition into making objects came

without announcement. His work now uses ash, gold, chrome, liquid metal, and carefully staged sculptural supports to ask questions that his earlier lives asked differently. The Buddha that projects out from a field of ashes, the gong that makes the face visible only through silence — these are not decorative choices. They are the residue of someone who has actually sat with these questions in multiple climates and found them still open. His practice has been described as materialist devotion, which he considers accurate, and as technologically sophisticated Buddhism, which he considers a compliment with an asterisk.

Series: The Weight of Impermanence

Floating Buddha I (2022)

Technique: Golden chrome seated Buddha statue, human ash, circular black canvas, ash pattern shaping, concealed support arm

Display: Gallery wall installation with concealed support, circular ash canvas

A small golden chrome seated Buddha projects outward from a circular canvas of abstract ash patterns — grey on black, stark and spare.

The Buddha projects several inches from the canvas on a concealed support, held just far enough from the surface to produce a charged spatial separation between figure and ground. Behind it, two kilograms of human ash — the average yield of a cremated adult body — form abstract patterns across a circular black canvas, fixed in place with conservation-grade adhesive. The patterns are not symbolic: no mandalas, no script, just the ash arranged in dense and loose areas, the grey of the material itself. The slight gap between sculpture and ash field gives the piece its tension, making the Buddha feel neither embedded in suffering nor free of it. Camus has said this is about the way enlightenment relates to suffering — not by transcending it, but by learning to remain just outside its grip.

Sister's Ocean (2023)

Technique: Human ash shaped into ocean wave patterns, memorial diamond, canvas, fine support mount

Display: Gallery wall installation with ash canvas and delicately mounted memorial diamond

A memorial diamond made from the artist's sister's ashes sits just in front of a canvas where ashes are shaped into ocean wave patterns.

The diamond is real — carbon extracted from Camus's sister's ashes and compressed into a one-carat stone that catches gallery light like trapped starlight. It is positioned just in front of ash waves that ripple across the canvas surface, the ashes shaped and fixed to suggest ocean movement, eternal circulation, the way grief moves through the body. The stone catches and throws brief rainbows across the grey waves behind it. This is the most personal piece in Camus's series and among the most delicate in construction, because the relation between the small jewel and the ash field behind it has to feel intimate without slipping into sentimentality.

Discourse Before Battle (2022)

Technique: Bronze Krishna and Arjuna figurines, human ash, canvas, detailed ash landscape shaping

Display: Gallery floor or pedestal installation, viewed from above

Small bronze figures of Krishna counseling Arjuna stand on a canvas field of ashes shaped into the Kurukshetra battlefield.

The figurines are positioned exactly as described in the Bhagavad Gita — Krishna in his charioteer's pose, Arjuna with his bow lowered, receiving the discourse that would become one of Hinduism's central texts. They stand on a canvas covered in ash shaped into the contours of the Kurukshetra battlefield, complete with formations, terrain features, the suggestion of armies. The ash field extends beyond the figures, implying that the battle they are discussing has already happened, that they are standing on its remains. Camus spent months studying battlefield archaeology to shape the ash formations with historical accuracy, turning the philosophical dialogue into a literal meditation on the cost of duty.

The Chariot Moves (2023)

Technique: Bronze Krishna and Arjuna figurines, miniature chariot with horses, human ash, canvas, detailed ash landscape shaping

Display: Gallery floor or pedestal installation, viewed from above, displayed as companion to Discourse Before Battle

Bronze figures of Krishna driving the chariot and Arjuna releasing his arrow stand in the thick of the Kurukshetra battlefield, surrounded by an ash field shaped into the chaos of active combat.

This is the companion to Discourse Before Battle - the moment after the words. The chariot is in motion now, or was: the miniature horses are mid-stride, Krishna leans into the reins, and Arjuna is no longer lowering his bow but drawing it. The ash field beneath them is denser, more disturbed, with formations breaking apart, the landscape no longer the clean topography of strategy but the churned ground of consequence. Camus treats the two pieces as a single diptych: one shows the world before action becomes irreversible, the other shows the world in which it already is. The question the two pieces ask together is whether knowing the cost ever changes the choosing.

Throne of Mortality (2023)

Technique: Antique historical throne, human ash, small smiling glass Buddha figure, dedicated room installation

Display: Dedicated room installation, museum or historic venue, antique throne as centerpiece

An antique throne in a regal room holds a mound of ashes; across the room, a small smiling multicolor glass Buddha stands watching.

Camus spent three years acquiring genuinely old thrones — a Qing dynasty chair, a fragment of a European baroque throne, a carved seat from Mali. In each iteration, the throne is specific, weighted with historical power. The ashes on it are anonymous, or claim to be. Across the room, the Buddha smiles in multicolor glass, a small, warm, apparently unconcerned presence. The space between them — a room you cross to pass from one to the other — is the whole argument of the piece. It asks whether the chair matters. It does not answer. It lets the ashes sit there instead.

Resonant Buddha (2023)

Technique: Golden chrome Buddha head sculpture, brass gong or bell, electric oscillator, programmed lighting control

Display: Dedicated dark room, museum installation

A golden chrome Buddha face emerging from a gong kept continuously vibrating by an electric oscillator; as the sound fades, the room dims until only the face is visible in silence.

Sound is the least permanent thing in any room. Camus uses this to make the Buddha's presence contingent on its opposite: when the gong speaks loudest, the room is fully lit and the face competes with everything else. As the oscillator lets the tone decay, the lights follow, and the face grows more prominent as the world grows quieter. By the time silence arrives, only the face remains. The piece enacts in real time the trajectory that meditation proposes — that the self becomes visible only as the noise subsides.

Gallium Canvas Buddha (2024)

Technique: Magnetic liquid metal Galinstan with iron nanoparticles, aged replica Gandhara Buddha sculpture, electromagnetic control system

Display: Gallery pedestal installation, controlled electromagnetic environment

A canvas of magnetic gallium alloy beneath a hovering aged replica of the seated Buddha of Pakistan; the metal surface responds to magnetic fields, creating a living ground beneath the still statue.

The magnetic gallium surface beneath the Buddha breathes. It responds to the piece's embedded electromagnets — subtle field changes cause the liquid metal to ripple, peak, flatten, form structures that almost look deliberate. The Buddha replica above — based on the great seated figure of the Gandhara period — hovers in studied stillness over all this activity. The contrast is precise: the still teacher, the agitated world below. The gallium is beautiful in the way that mercury is beautiful: completely amoral, utterly physical, with no interest in what it means.

Sequence This (Samurai) (2024)

Technique: Extracted DNA, magnetized sculpture of samurai mid-thrust, magnetic gallium coating, display case

Display: Gallery vitrine or pedestal, enclosed display

A small samurai sculpture coated in magnetic gallium stands mid-thrust over a field of crystallized DNA, the blade driving toward the molecular substrate of life.

DNA, extracted and dried, looks like spun sugar. It is neither dramatic nor particularly impressive in person. Camus counts on this. The magnetic gallium-coated samurai — caught at the instant of a full committed sword thrust, weight forward, both hands on the grip — drives into the anticlimactic white crystals below. The posture is borrowed from classical kenjutsu documentation: a move designed to end things decisively. The piece asks what it means to apply that level of committed force to something as quiet and involuntary as the code that made you. The DNA does not defend itself. It does not need to.

Sequence This (Moctezuma Ilhuicamina) (2024)

Technique: Extracted DNA, magnetized sculpture of Moctezuma I drawing a bow, magnetic gallium coating, display case

Display: Gallery vitrine or pedestal, enclosed display

A small sculpture of Moctezuma Ilhuicamina drawing his bow, coated in magnetic gallium, takes aim over a field of crystallized DNA.

Moctezuma Ilhuicamina — the first great Mexica emperor, whose name means He Who Frowns Like a Lord and He Who Shoots the Sky with an Arrow — is rendered here at the moment of drawing: the bow arm extended, the string pulled to full tension, gaze fixed on something beyond the frame. He stands on a field of extracted, crystallized DNA. The gallium coating makes the figure flicker under gallery light, neither fully solid nor fully liquid. The arrow has not yet been released. The DNA cannot move. Camus has said this is the most honest piece in the series: the figure of historical will, encoded possibility, and the long pause before the shot.

Sequence This (Geronimo) (2024)

Technique: Extracted DNA, magnetized sculpture of Geronimo raising his shotgun, magnetic gallium coating, display case

Display: Gallery vitrine or pedestal, enclosed display

A small sculpture of Geronimo raising his shotgun, coated in magnetic gallium, stands over a field of crystallized DNA — resistance encoded in the substrate of life.

Geronimo held out longer than anyone had a right to expect. The gallium-coated figure captures him in the posture most associated with his surviving photographs: upright, rifle raised, the expression of a man who has calculated the odds and decided they are irrelevant. He stands on extracted, crystallized DNA — real genetic material, anonymous, the kind of code that persists regardless of what happens to the body it came from. The piece turns on this: the last Apache leader who refused to surrender, standing on the molecular evidence of continuity. The shotgun is raised. The DNA is still there. Both are true at the same time.

Floating Buddha II (2023)

Technique: Golden chrome standing Buddha statue, human ash, circular black canvas, concealed support arm

Display: Gallery wall installation with concealed support, displayed as companion to Floating Buddha I

A standing golden chrome Buddha projects outward from a circular canvas of abstract ash patterns — grey on black, pure and spare.

The canvas is round. The ash patterns are abstract — no symbols, no script, no reference. Just the material arranged in broad, slow spirals that start dense at the edge and thin toward the center, the grey of ash against black. The standing Buddha extends several inches from the surface, its posture upright and engaged. Camus has said the standing figure is the complement to the seated one: if the first piece is about staying just outside suffering, this one is about moving through it. The circular canvas gives the piece a different gravity than a rectangle — the ash patterns feel less like a backdrop and more like a field the Buddha has arrived from.

Floating Buddha III (2024)

Technique: Reclining golden chrome Buddha statue, human ash, circular black canvas, concealed support arm

Display: Gallery wall installation, circular format, concealed support

A reclining golden chrome Buddha — the parinirvana posture — projects outward from a large circular canvas of abstract ash patterns, the grey of the ash spreading outward from the center in loose, irregular waves.

The reclining Buddha is the posture of final passing: parinirvana. The circular canvas behind it holds only ash — no symbols, no references, nothing that would translate into language. The patterns are abstract and irregular: the ash gathers in loose concentric forms that break apart, cluster, thin out. The circle contains the whole field without framing it as a picture. The reclining figure extends only a few inches from the surface, very close, as though it has just settled there. Camus has described this as the only one of the three Buddhas that is not about practice. It is about arrival.

Magdalena Hofstetter-Cruz

Vienna-born and Guadalajara-based, Hofstetter-Cruz works with heavy metals, prehistoric materials, and resonant physical phenomena to create installations that treat deep time as a sculptural medium.

Magdalena Hofstetter-Cruz has an unusual commitment to working with materials that are either very old or very dangerous. Mercury appears in multiple pieces. A mammoth tusk. Gallium at room temperature. Ancient bones. The effect is not nihilist — quite the opposite. Her work insists on the materiality of deep time, on the fact that the universe's history is lying around on the floor of natural history museums in glass cases, waiting for someone to do something with it. She does things with it, and the institutions are sometimes unhappy about this, which she accepts as an occupational condition.

Series: Suspended Prehistory

Mammoth in Mercury (2023)

Technique: Mammoth tusk fossil, mercury bath, sealed display enclosure

Display: Sealed gallery installation with safety enclosure, museum with conservation clearances

A mammoth tusk floating in a mercury bath.

The mammoth tusk is perhaps fifteen thousand years old. The mercury bath is extremely contemporary in its danger and its beauty. Both are products of geological time — the tusk from a cold megafauna extinction, the mercury from hydrothermal deposits formed over millions of years. Together, they constitute a meeting of two deep-time materials in a room full of people taking photographs on glass rectangles. The mercury reflects the tusk from below, producing a second tusk, inverted, in silver. Hofstetter-Cruz has noted that the piece requires mercury, and mercury is toxic, and this has not deterred her.

Mercury Ossuary (2023)

Technique: Animal bones of varied species, mercury bath, sealed enclosure

Display: Sealed gallery installation, museum with safety clearances

Bones of various animals — dog, small birds, larger birds, Komodo dragon — floating on a mercury bath.

The bones float on the mercury's surface due to its extraordinary density, which Hofstetter-Cruz considers the actual subject of the piece. The bones are not dramatic. A dog's femur, a bird's hollow rib, the articulated vertebrae of something larger — they rest on the silver surface as though on water, except that nothing about mercury is like water. The ossuary form — a place of secondary burial, a repository of bones that have been through the world — takes on a new register when the ground is toxic and reflective and will outlast everything in the room including the building.

Quetzalcoatl Maglev (2024)

Technique: Metal recreation of Quetzalcoatl sculpture, magnetic levitation system, mercury bath

Display: Gallery pedestal installation, controlled magnetic environment

A 50cm metal recreation of the Quetzalcoatl from the Louvre, levitating above a mercury bath.

Hofstetter-Cruz takes one of Mesoamerica's most important deities — currently housed in Paris — and recreates it in metal at a scale that fits in a room, levitating above a mercury bath by magnetic force. The levitation is

not subtle. The god floats. Conspicuously, defiantly, like a claim. The mercury beneath mirrors it and completes the figure. Whether the piece is about the colonial displacement of cultural objects, the physics of magnetic fields, or both is something Hofstetter-Cruz leaves to the viewer, having put everything necessary for either reading right there in the room.

Liquid Metal Centurion (2023)

Technique: Original Roman helmet, magnetic gallium alloy Galinstan, electromagnetic field control

Display: Gallery pedestal installation, controlled electromagnetic field environment

An original Roman helmet covered in magnetically attached liquid gallium alloy that moves and reforms according to changes in the surrounding magnetic field.

The helmet predates the art market by roughly two thousand years. Hofstetter-Cruz acquired it and covered it in a magnetic gallium alloy that attaches to the metal surface and responds to the embedded electromagnetic field. The silver liquid moves across the ancient iron — pooling, draining, forming shapes in the visor, filling the plume channel, draining again. Roman soldiers were teenagers. Most of them died of dysentery. The gallium does not know any of this. It moves because it must, which is possibly what the soldiers were also doing.

Seo-Yeon Park

Seoul and Berlin-based, Park creates perceptual and kinetic installations that explore color, light, and the physics of experience. Her work asks viewers to question the reliability of their own perception.

Seo-Yeon Park's installations are traps, affectionately laid. You look into the Reflective Sphere and cannot quite determine what you are seeing. You watch the ferrofluid circle divide and are not sure whether it is separating or coming together. You stand before the Analog Color Generator and see a painting that is not there. Park is interested in the boundary between the physical world and the perceptual one — not as philosophical abstraction but as lived, bodily experience. Her work is

rigorously engineered and deliberately disorienting, which she considers the same thing.

Series: Perceptual Fields

Reflective Sphere (2023)

Technique: Two large mirrored hemispheres, one-way mirror interior room, gap lighting, aperture in upper dome, exterior staircase

Display: Large-scale outdoor or atrium installation, minimum ceiling clearance six meters, staircase structure required

Two massive mirrored hemispheres slightly separated at the equator, admitting a band of light between them. Inside the lower half, a small room of one-way mirrors lets a person stand inside the sphere and look out. A staircase on the exterior lets visitors look in through the gap.

The structure is two stories tall and divided at the horizon. The upper and lower hemispheres do not quite meet — a gap of roughly thirty centimeters runs around the equator, admitting a continuous ring of ambient light into the mirrored interior. A second aperture opens at the crown of the upper dome, directing a column of light straight down the axis of the sphere. Inside the lower hemisphere, accessible through a concealed entrance, a small room built entirely from one-way mirrors gives a single visitor at a time the experience of standing at the center of infinite recursive reflection while remaining invisible to everyone outside. Above, other visitors climb an exterior staircase to the equatorial gap and look in — seeing their own faces multiplied across the curved mirrored interior, unaware that someone may be standing directly below them, watching. The piece proposes two simultaneous and incompatible experiences of the same space: the hidden center and the exposed periphery, interiority and display, the person who sees without being seen and the person who is seen without knowing it.

Kinetic Liquid Pigment: Primal Duality (2024)

Technique: Ferrofluid with nano-pigment, liquid pigment background, electromagnetic field control, table or canvas container

Display: Gallery table installation or floor-level canvas container

A yellow ferromagnetic circle floats on a blue liquid field — controlled by magnets it divides into two circles, merges, and divides again.

The piece is almost embarrassingly direct in its symbolism and does not apologize for this. A circle divides. The circle is yellow. The ground is blue. The colors produced at the boundary are briefly green. Whether this refers to cellular division, the Big Bang, romantic separation, or the Taoist concept of duality is a question that Park considers the viewer's responsibility, not hers. She has provided the magnet. She has provided the ferrofluid. She has provided the colors. The rest is your autobiography.

Han River at Night (2024)

Technique: Three translucent CMYK-printed sheets, spaced at fixed depth intervals, parallax-registered layered overlap, physical color mixing

Display: Gallery installation, freestanding or wall-mounted, best viewed in low ambient light; the viewing position is critical

Three translucent sheets spaced apart at fixed depths reconstruct a nighttime panorama of the Han River — but the image only locks in when viewed straight-on through the front. Step to the side and the layers come apart.

The Han River cuts through Seoul the way rivers cut through every city that grew too fast: it is both the reason the city is there and the thing the city learned to ignore. Park reconstructs the contemporary riverfront — the illuminated bridges, the apartment towers in their hundreds, the Lotte World Tower catching cloud — from three sheets of translucent CMYK print separated by deliberate gaps in depth. Viewed from directly in front, parallax aligns the layers and the image resolves: a complete nighttime panorama assembled from nothing but overlapping color. Move even slightly to the side and the sheets drift apart, each layer sliding against the others, the city disassembling into colored fragments. The piece is always there. The image is not. It belongs only to the position you are standing in. The piece asks whether the modern Seoul skyline — the one that is supposed to represent arrival — is the kind of thing that exists only from one very specific angle.

Boseong Tea Fields (2024)

Technique: Three translucent CMYK-printed sheets, spaced at fixed depth intervals, parallax-registered layered overlap, physical color mixing

Display: Gallery installation, freestanding or wall-mounted; the viewing position is critical

Three translucent sheets spaced apart at fixed depths reconstruct the terraced green tea fields of Boseong — but the rows only align into a coherent landscape when viewed straight-on through the front. Move sideways and the layers separate.

The Boseong tea fields in South Jeolla province are among the oldest continuously worked agricultural landscapes in Korea. The terraces were shaped by hand over generations, their geometry following the logic of water and slope rather than the logic of industry. Park encodes this landscape into three sheets of translucent print separated by deliberate gaps in depth. Stand directly in front and parallax aligns them: the green rows appear, curved and precise, climbing the hillside in the direction they have always climbed. Step to the side and the rows slide against each other, each layer carrying only its fragment of hue and tone, the hillside coming apart into color. The piece treats the pre-industrial landscape not as nostalgia but as a positional argument: this place exists, completely and correctly, from exactly here. The tea fields have a four-hundred-year precedent for this kind of precision. They were also shaped to be seen from one specific vantage — the path up the slope — and from nowhere else.

The 38th Parallel (2024)

Technique: Six translucent CMYK-printed rotating sheets in two sets of three, motorized rotation, historical cartographic source material, layered physical color mixing

Display: Gallery installation, freestanding, requires clearance for six-sheet rotating mechanism

Six motorized translucent sheets — three encoding the militarized DMZ, three encoding the same coordinates before 1945 — rotate at different speeds, cycling through moments where each landscape resolves alone,

moments where both dissolve into abstraction, and moments where the wire and the rice paddy exist in the same place at the same time.

The piece uses two sets of three translucent CMYK sheets, each set encoding a different version of the same geography. One set carries the contemporary DMZ: the razor wire in the foreground, the watchtower at the treeline, the accidental wilderness that seventy years of enforced absence has produced. The other set carries the same hills, the same treeline, as they appeared before 1945 — rice paddies, a village whose name survives only in pre-division cartographic records, a road that continued north without explanation. The six sheets rotate at carefully mismatched speeds so their convergences are never repeated. There are moments when each landscape resolves cleanly on its own — the wire fully legible, or the paddy fully legible — and moments when the two images overlap and neither is fully coherent: watchtower rising from a rice field, wire crossing a road that leads somewhere. The piece does not editorialize about which image is the real one. It simply keeps rotating. Park has noted that the DMZ has been undisturbed long enough that Siberian tigers have been photographed inside it. She considers this relevant.

Carmen Llorente-Vidal

Born in Valencia and working in Mexico City, Llorente-Vidal uses light, laser, and chromatographic processes to find the art that the material already contains.

Carmen Llorente-Vidal has described her practice as finding the art that the material already contains. She works with lasers through scattering media, with plant dyes running up paper, with prism grids that split light. Her portraits of revolutionaries are made not of paint but of photons organized by acrylic geometry. Her chromatography works are collaborations with chlorophyll and anthocyanin and whatever the beet decides to do under capillary action. She is not interested in imposing form, which makes her a somewhat unusual choice for the contemporary art market, which is predominantly interested in imposing form.

Series: Traces and Wavelengths

Zapata Light Portrait (2024)

Technique: Laser, acrylic refractive panels, Intralipid scattering medium in distilled water

Display: Dark gallery room with laser safety protocols, individual portrait installation

Portrait of Emiliano Zapata rendered as laser line drawing refracted through acrylic and liquid scattering media — a face that exists only when the laser runs.

The face of Zapata is reconstituted from light. Llorente-Vidal carves the acrylic geometry that forces the laser beam into the lines of his distinctive mustache, the angle of his revolutionary hat, the determined set of his jaw. The medium is Intralipid diluted to 0.05 percent in distilled water — a medical emulsion designed to feed patients who cannot eat, repurposed to scatter light in a tank. Zapata's face exists only when the laser runs. When the power is off, the tank is just water. The piece asks whether revolutionary memory persists in the same way light does — present only when the conditions are right for it to be seen.

Che Light Portrait (2024)

Technique: Laser, acrylic refractive panels, titanium dioxide scattering medium in distilled water

Display: Dark gallery room with laser safety protocols, individual portrait installation

Portrait of Che Guevara rendered as laser line drawing refracted through acrylic and liquid scattering media — focusing on the precise angle of his iconic beret.

Che's face emerges from photons and engineering. Llorente-Vidal uses titanium dioxide instead of Intralipid here, creating a different scattering quality that emphasizes the precise angle of the beret, the intensity of the gaze that has been reproduced on a million t-shirts. The laser traces the lines of the most photographed revolutionary in history, but only when the machine is running. Turn off the power and the icon dissolves back into industrial chemistry and water. The piece suggests that even the most enduring images are contingent on the technologies that produce them.

Zapatista Comandante Light Portrait (2024)

Technique: Laser, acrylic refractive panels, fluorescent dye scattering medium in distilled water

Display: Dark gallery room with laser safety protocols, individual portrait installation

Portrait of a masked Zapatista commander rendered as laser line drawing — the anonymity of the mask translated into the ephemeral nature of light.

The masked profile of a Zapatista commander is traced in light through fluorescent dye medium, the anonymity of the subject perfectly suited to the ephemeral nature of the medium. Llorente-Vidal emphasizes the mask's edges, the fabric folds, the deliberate concealment that becomes a form of revelation when rendered in laser light. The piece exists only during activation — when the laser stops, the revolutionary dissolves back into chemistry. This impermanence mirrors the Zapatista philosophy of leadership without faces, of revolution as process rather than monument.

Netaji Light Portrait (2024)

Technique: Laser, acrylic refractive panels, Intralipid scattering medium in distilled water

Display: Dark gallery room with laser safety protocols, individual portrait installation

Portrait of Subhas Chandra Bose (Netaji) rendered as laser line drawing refracted through acrylic and liquid scattering media.

Netaji's face is assembled from light and medical emulsion, his determined features traced by laser through Intralipid-scattered water. Llorente-Vidal captures the intensity that led him to challenge both British colonialism and Gandhi's non-violence, the face that appeared on the first currency of the Provisional Government of Free India. The portrait exists only when the laser runs — a fitting medium for a leader whose legacy remains contested, whose memory flickers between heroism and controversy. When the power stops, Bose returns to the realm of historical debate, leaving only water and chemistry.

Archaeological Material Timeline (2023)

Technique: Wall mosaic, construction materials from multiple historical eras, masonry techniques spanning millennia

Display: Museum wall installation, architectural integration, structural or decorative depending on venue

A large wall composed of dozens of construction materials from different historical periods — adobe, Roman concrete, medieval mortar, industrial brick, modern composite — arranged chronologically.

Architecture is geology's autobiography. Llorente-Vidal assembles a cross-section through human building history in a single wall: each section a different material, a different technique, a different moment in the long project of keeping weather out. The wall is load-bearing. She insisted on this. It has to actually work. A wall that only pretends to be structural would be a different piece — a museum display. Llorente-Vidal wanted the weight to be real, because the history is real, because every material in this wall was pulled from the same ground that is now under your feet.

Ana Camus

Series: All You Need is Love

Chladni Plate Cymatics Art Works (2024)

Technique: Chladni plate vibration, colored sand, glue fixative, layered cymatics, DNA component sand variants

Display: Gallery wall series, multiple format sizes, triptych configuration

Multi-layered cymatics patterns built up layer by layer with different colored sands on vibrating plates, fixed with glue between frequencies. Variants use the four DNA base component colors.

Chladni patterns are what sound looks like when it has nowhere else to go. Hofstetter-Cruz layers them, one atop another — first one frequency fixed and glued, then another, then another — building up a geological record of

vibration. In the DNA variants using the four base components as color-coded sand, the piece acquires an additional layer: the pattern of life's code forming the pattern of sound's geometry. Whether these two codes have anything to say to each other is a question that the piece declines to answer but insists on asking, in triptych format and small.

Mayan Heaven (2025)

Technique: Distilled water, optional colloidal silica and copper sulfate, 5-meter-deep tank 1m wide 1m tall, matte black panels, dark metal frame

Display: Dedicated gallery room, tank embedded in floor or framed as viewing window in wall

A five-meter-deep water tank one meter wide and tall, enclosed in matte black — showing pure water's gradient from near-transparent at the shallows to deep celestial blue at full depth, with no pigment added.

This is the most restrained piece in Park's practice and possibly the most profound. No pigment. No electricity. No moving parts. Just water, depth, and the physics of light absorption — the same phenomenon that makes the Caribbean blue, that makes the deep ocean black. The water at five meters absorbs the red end of the visible spectrum and scatters blue back to you. You are looking at color generated by absence and distance. The matte black enclosure removes all competing reference. The metal frame eliminates warmth. And the cenote-blue you see at the bottom is not a recreation — it is the same physics. The piece is called Mayan Heaven not as metaphor but as description.

Indigo Study: Natural vs Synthetic (2023)

Technique: Paper chromatography, natural anil indigo, synthetic indigo, capillary action separation

Display: Gallery wall display, framed chromatography paper

Chromatographic comparison of natural indigo from anil plants alongside synthetic indigo, separated by capillary action on paper.

Two drops of blue. One from the anil plant that has colored textiles for centuries, one from industrial chemistry. Llorente-Vidal places them side by side on chromatography paper and lets capillary action reveal what each blue is made of. The natural indigo separates into subtle variations — traces of plant matter, organic compounds that traveled with the color. The

synthetic remains pure, uniform, predictable. The paper becomes a timeline of how humans learned to remake what plants already knew. The capillary action is the artist here; Llorente-Vidal simply chooses which blues to test against each other.

Cochineal Study: Insect vs Chemical (2023)

Technique: Paper chromatography, cochineal red from insects, alizarin red synthetic dye, capillary action separation

Display: Gallery wall display, framed chromatography paper

Chromatographic comparison of red dye made from cochineal insects against synthetic alizarin red, revealing the complex chemistry of natural versus artificial color.

The red that comes from crushed cochineal insects carries more than color — it carries the entire chemistry of the insect's life, feeding on cactus, processing sunlight, metabolizing plant sugars into carminic acid. When run through chromatography against synthetic alizarin, the natural red explodes into complexity: traces of proteins, organic acids, compounds that have no name but create subtle variations in hue. The synthetic red travels as a single, pure band. Both are beautiful. Both are red. Only one remembers being alive.

Mexican Market Pigment Studies (2023)

Technique: Paper chromatography, mixed plant pigments from Mexican markets, capillary action separation

Display: Gallery wall series, multiple framed chromatography papers

Chromatographic studies of plant pigments sourced from Mexican markets — revealing the hidden complexity of traditional dyes through scientific separation.

The market vendors sell color that has been traveling for centuries: annatto for orange, huitlacoche for black, various flowers for yellow. Llorente-Vidal treats each pigment as a mystery to be solved through chromatography. The papers bloom with unexpected separations — a yellow that contains traces of green, a brown that reveals hidden purples, plant chemistry confessing its secrets through capillary action. Each market produces different results because the plants grow in different soil, under different weather, harvested by different hands. The chromatography papers

become portraits of specific places and seasons, rendered in the language of molecular movement.

Mother's Dress (2024)

Technique: Fabric, Chladni plate cymatics patterns, optional natural chromatography dye, Venus of Willendorf shaped mannequin

Display: Gallery installation on mannequin pedestal, single work or paired with a plain companion dress

A dress adorned with Chladni plate cymatics patterns and natural chromatography pigment designs displayed on a Venus of Willendorf shaped mannequin.

The Venus of Willendorf is approximately thirty thousand years old and has no face. Llorente-Vidal dresses her in a gown. The gown carries the patterns of vibrating plates — the shapes that sound takes when it settles and optionally the tracks that plants leave when their colors run. The oldest known representation of a female body wears a garment whose patterns are determined by physics and biology. Fertility, resonance, pigment, time. Llorente-Vidal insists it is also about her mother, and this is the detail that the art world tends to skip over, which probably means it is the most important part.

Amara Sidibe Kouyate

Born in Bamako and based in Paris, Sidibe Kouyate creates immersive installations reimagining public and domestic space, memory, and cultural displacement through architecture, sensory experience, and intimate gesture.

Amara Sidibe Kouyate's work is about the rooms we carry with us: the museum we have always been inside, the embrace we return to, the grief that pours itself into something physical. She makes small models of existing museums and fills them with new curation. She makes an embrace you can walk into. She makes fountains of salt from the nearest ocean. Her installations are precisely engineered to produce specific emotional states, which she considers the most rigorous form of

conceptual art and which critics sometimes mistake for sentimentality. She accepts this confusion as part of the work.

Series: Familiar Architectures

Small Museums (2022)

Technique: Scale models, miniature curated artworks, VR camera system, custom VR headset experience

Display: Gallery table installation with VR headset station alongside

Detailed scale models of existing museums, each with a curated selection of miniature artworks. The curation is the art piece. A VR experience lets visitors navigate the model with a tiny roving camera.

The museum is already a work of art — a selection of objects presented as important, framed by architecture designed to amplify their importance. Sidibe Kouyate makes models of the models: the Louvre, the Tate, the Smithsonian at hand scale, their interiors rearranged by her curation. A Benin Bronze adjacent to a Koons. A Kachina figure next to a Greek amphora. The VR camera moves through the spaces at eye level, generating the scale sensation of tiny museum rooms. The curation becomes the argument. The model becomes the country you are standing in.

Cyberpunk Estela de Luz (2023)

Technique: Scale model, LED lighting systems, fog machines, laser-cut cyberpunk details, custom miniature fabrication

Display: Museum vitrine installation, darkened room to enhance LED effects

A scale model of Mexico City's Estela de Luz reimagined as a dystopian cyberpunk monument in a neon-lit night city.

The Estela de Luz — a monument whose inauguration was delayed by corruption scandals and whose symbolism was contested from the start — becomes, in Sidibe Kouyate's hands, exactly what its critics always said it was: a monument to power without substance. The cyberpunk version makes this literal: neon lights cascade down its surface, fog machines

create atmospheric pollution, tiny LED advertisements flicker in languages that don't exist. The surrounding miniature cityscape shows Mexico City as cyberpunk dystopia, but the transformation required is disturbingly minimal. The piece asks whether the monument was always science fiction, and whether science fiction was always documentary.

Reclaimed Eiffel Tower (2023)

Technique: Scale model, miniature vegetation, tiny architectural details, mixed natural and synthetic materials

Display: Museum vitrine installation, natural lighting preferred

The Eiffel Tower covered in dense vegetation with tiny human settlements hanging from its iron structure — colonial ruin photography applied to Paris.

The Eiffel Tower, which Parisians hated on its construction and now cannot live without, grows vines and sprouts tiny dwellings until it becomes exactly the kind of inhabited ruin that colonial photography attributed to everyone else. Sidibe Kouyate covers the iron lattice with miniature vegetation — real moss, tiny plastic vines, microscopic flowering plants — while small huts and rope bridges hang from the structure's geometry. The piece reverses the colonial gaze: Paris becomes the picturesque ruin, the Tower becomes the romantic decay, and the inhabitants become the noble savages living in harmony with abandoned European infrastructure. The reversal is meticulous and not gentle.

The Playful Museum (2023)

Technique: Hidden cameras in artworks, live feed, digital display or print, two-room installation

Display: Two-room museum gallery installation with camera and printing or projection system

In the first room artworks photograph viewers; in the second, visitors find themselves inserted into the very paintings and sculptures they observed moments before.

The museum gaze is usually one-directional: the art sits still; you move around it; you look; it does not look back. Sidibe Kouyate reverses the direction in room one and completes the circuit in room two. What you thought was passive observation was documentation. What you thought

was a Vermeer is now a Vermeer containing you, in your current expression. The slight time delay — usually less than a minute — means you almost recognize the version of yourself from before you knew you were being watched. It is an extremely flattering mirror and an extremely uncomfortable one, which is what mirrors usually are.

Alejandro Corona

Mexican, Alejandro Corona creates immersive installations that use technology and domestic materials to produce moments of permission, mystical experience, and profound comfort. His practice bridges high-tech systems with the textures of home and family memory.

Alejandro Corona makes work about permission — permission to rest, permission to transcend, permission to be held. His installations use sophisticated technology not to create futuristic experiences but to access the most ancient human feelings: the suspension of ordinary time, the sensation of rising above oneself, the unconditional embrace of childhood. Whether through synchronized silence systems, VR mystical experiences, or room-scale domestic comfort, his work insists that technology's highest purpose is to restore what industrialization took away. Critics have called his practice 'technologically sophisticated sentimentality,' which he considers both accurate and the point.

Sometimes It's OK to Just... (2022)

Technique: Multiple analog and digital clocks, synchronized silence programming, room installation

Display: Gallery room installation, visitors free to move around

A room full of clocks that periodically all fall silent at once.

The title refuses to finish its sentence, which is the whole piece. A room of ticking clocks is a room of small insinuations, each one arguing for the reality of continuous time. When they stop — all of them, together, in a silence that has no schedule but will arrive — the effect is not dramatic. It is strange. The absence of tick is louder than any of the ticks were

individually. What the room offers is a break in the argument that time makes about itself every second of every day. Whether this constitutes permission is the viewer's responsibility.

VR Mystical Experience (2024)

Technique: VR headset, external rising camera, spatial audio with mystical birds, flutes, and drone music

Display: Gallery installation, multiple VR stations, ambient spatial sound system

Visitors wear VR headsets and see through a camera that rises above them, showing them from above while mystical soundscapes play.

The out-of-body experience has been reported by approximately ten percent of the population during near-death events, under anesthesia, or in moments of extreme physical stress. Corona offers it on demand, in a gallery, with flutes. The camera lifts. You see yourself from above — small, in a crowd of others also wearing headsets, also looking up at themselves. The birds sing. The drone sounds. You are briefly your own satellite image. Whether this is mystical experience or its complete simulation is a question that anyone who has had either version will tell you cannot be answered from the outside.

Abuelita Sweater (2023)

Technique: Hand-sewn oversized knitted garment, transparent acrylic floor panel, soft ambient lighting

Display: Gallery floor installation, room-scale, visitors enter the piece physically

An enormous hand-sewn sweater whose open arms enfold the viewer; the bottom hem lies on the floor under clear acrylic, walked over as you enter the embrace.

The piece is formally very simple and emotionally not simple at all. A sweater large enough to wrap around an adult standing in it, arms extended at gallery scale, soft knit, grandmother scale. The bottom hem lies flat on the floor under transparent acrylic — you walk over it to enter, stepping on the garment before it surrounds you. Corona has said this is about the way love always involves standing on something that is also loving you. Critics have said this is sentimental. He considers

sentimentality underrated as both a formal strategy and an emotional technology.

Bjorn Thielemann

Hamburg-born and widely traveled, Thielemann makes work that interrogates the commodification of culture, art history, and the body through vending machines, display cases, pop aesthetics, and large-scale performative noise.

Bjorn Thielemann spent years in advertising before having what he describes as an ethical crisis that took longer than it should have. His work since then has been an extended forensic examination of what it means to put a price on something sacred — which, he has noted, is what advertising does and what the art market does and what vending machines do, and the distinctions between these three activities are narrower than comfortable. He is good-humored about this. He is not forgiving about it.

Series: Icons for Sale

Golden Venus (2022)

Technique: Gold-chromed replica sculpture, vending machine, gallery installation

Display: Gallery floor installation, functioning vending machine

A gold-chromed replica of the Venus of Willendorf inside a vending machine, available for purchase.

The Venus of Willendorf is thirty thousand years old and may be the first representation of a human body ever made. Thielemann puts it in a vending machine. You can purchase it for three euros and fifty cents, or you can look at it behind the glass and decline, which is also a valid transaction. The gold chrome finish is aspirational and slightly tacky in the way that gold always is when it is not actually gold. The vending machine hum is the most contemporary sound in the room.

Huge Golden Venus (2022)

Technique: Large-scale golden chrome sculpture, outdoor or atrium installation

Display: Outdoor public installation, museum atrium, or large gallery space

A monumental golden chrome version of the Venus of Willendorf at architectural scale.

Where the vending machine Venus is a question about scale and access, the Huge Golden Venus answers with pure excess. The thirty-thousand-year-old figure enlarged to monumental scale in golden chrome is simultaneously a fertility monument, an act of reverence, a comment on art market inflation, and an extremely large object. What Thielemann does not do is make her thin. She is enlarged at her original proportions. In a cultural context that remains systematically hostile to large bodies, this is either a neutral formal decision or a small pointed one.

Victory Commodified (2023)

Technique: High-quality marble miniature replica, vending machine, gallery installation

Display: Gallery floor installation, functioning vending machine, paired with Golden Venus machine

A high-quality marble miniature of the Winged Victory of Samothrace inside a vending machine.

The Winged Victory — currently in the Louvre, missing her head, triumphant anyway — becomes a dispensable item. The marble miniature is genuinely good quality; Thielemann insisted on this. You are not buying a cheap reproduction. You are buying an excellent reproduction of a thing that itself is a monument to winning something that the people who built it subsequently lost. The vending machine format makes the question of cultural ownership feel bodily — you reach into the dispensing tray; you hold history in your hand; you take it home in a plastic bag.

Damian (2023)

Technique: Scale figure of Damien Hirst, formaldehyde-reference tank, vending machine

Display: Gallery floor installation, vending machine

A small figure of Damien Hirst floating in a vat, contained within a vending machine.

Hirst spent considerable energy and capital putting dead animals in formaldehyde tanks and calling it art. Thielemann returns the gesture. The figure is recognizable — unmistakably Hirst — and floats in a tank that references the artist's most famous series. Whether this constitutes critique, homage, or market commentary is as impossible to determine as it was with the original pieces. The vending machine contains everything: the artist, the medium, the price point, the transaction. It costs four euros.

The Mosh Pit Experience Machine (2024)

Technique: Pneumatic padding system, vibrating floor and walls, surround video screens, spatial audio at concert volume

Display: Gallery room or booth installation, sound-isolated, visitor warning and waiver required

A small padded room displaying mosh pit and concert imagery, with vibrating walls and pneumatic mechanisms that physically push and punch the visitor from all sides.

The mosh pit is a participatory art form that has never been shown in a gallery without removing everything that makes it meaningful. Thielemann makes a machine that restores the body. The walls display concert footage on all sides — SOAD, Korn, the particular chaos of a sold-out metal show at eleven PM. Then the room punches you. Not hard enough to injure. Hard enough to constitute an event. The vibration is continuous. The sound is at concert volume. Visitors report that it is either deeply unpleasant or the best thing in the gallery, which is exactly the mosh pit experience the machine is describing.

Dream On (2024)

Technique: Live turtles or robotic turtle models, bright neon green liquid, gallery floor installation

Display: Gallery floor installation, open space

Four small turtles walking toward a container spilling bright green liquid.

There is no explanation provided for this piece. Thielemann refuses to offer one in interviews, catalogue essays, or even private conversation. Four turtles. Bright green liquid. The liquid spills. The turtles approach. This is either the most profound piece in the exhibition or the most empty, and the confident determination of critics to place it in one category or the other is itself the subject of the work — or at least something the work is happy to exploit. The green is very bright.

Tadashi Nomura

Osaka-born illustrator and book artist working between Japan and Germany, Nomura creates illustrated books and visual narratives that engage death, impermanence, absurdity, and the monsters we keep inside.

Tadashi Nomura began as a manga artist, moved into conceptual illustration, and now occupies a space that does not have a conventional genre name. His children's books contain genuinely frightening creatures. His adult books contain genuine tenderness. He is interested in the horizontal format — the scroll, the panorama, the panel that cannot be contained on a vertical page — and in the formal discipline of the single line, the single stroke, the drawing that refuses color. He has described himself as a person trying to draw what everyone already knows is true, in a language no one has to learn.

Series: For Small Eyes and Heavy Hearts

The Jenga Demon (2024)

Technique: Ink illustration, full color, individual art print

Display: Gallery print, children's art exhibition or adult contemporary space

An absurdist monster built from Jenga blocks in perpetual collapse, reaching desperately for a bottle of glue.

The Jenga Demon has the specific terror of a thing that is always in the process of falling, and its redemption arc — finding glue — is the simplest possible description of how most recovery actually works. Nomura draws

it with the careful attention usually reserved for children, which means the accuracy is devastating and the affection is real. The demon's eyes show the particular exhaustion of holding yourself together when the structural integrity was never quite there to begin with.

The Water-Faucet-Eyed Monster (2024)

Technique: Ink illustration, full color, individual art print

Display: Gallery print, therapeutic or educational exhibition

A creature whose eyes are actual water faucets, constantly leaking or flowing with different intensities of emotion.

Some emotions require constant drainage. Nomura's Water-Faucet-Eyed Monster turns crying into plumbing — functional, mechanical, occasionally requiring maintenance. The creature cannot stop the flow, but it can control the volume, which is a reasonable metaphor for emotional regulation that does not insult children by pretending feelings can be turned off entirely. The monster is neither tragic nor comic. It is practical.

The Freedom Monster (2024)

Technique: Ink illustration, full color, individual art print

Display: Gallery print, contemporary adult art space

An over-complicated creature with multiplying eyes, exoskeletal arms, extra mechanical parts, wheels, and unnecessary appendages — freedom as overwhelming choice.

The Freedom Monster has multiplying eyes and exoskeletal arms and an extra mechanical nose and wheels and legs and is trying too hard in a way recognizable to anyone over thirty. Nomura draws it with genuine affection for the exhaustion of infinite options. The monster represents the particular anxiety of having too much choice, too much possibility, too much freedom to optimize — and the way liberation can become its own cage when it requires you to figure out who you are from scratch every morning.

The Shame Monster (2024)

Technique: Ink illustration, full color emphasis on red, individual art print

Display: Gallery print, psychological or emotional art exhibition

A permanently red creature with furnace-temperature cheeks, accurate social portraiture of the feeling of being seen and found lacking.

The Shame Monster is always red, its cheeks at furnace-temperature, and constitutes social portraiture of devastating accuracy. Nomura refuses to make shame cute or manageable — this is the real heat of being seen and found lacking, of walking into a room and knowing immediately that you are dressed wrong, speaking wrong, existing wrong. The monster cannot cool down. The monster cannot hide. The monster has learned to live with being the color of embarrassment, which is either tragedy or wisdom, and possibly both.

The Anger Monster (2024)

Technique: Ink illustration, full color with dramatic contrasts, individual art print

Display: Gallery print, emotional education exhibition

A creature whose form changes size and intensity based on the legitimacy and scale of its rage.

The Anger Monster appears differently depending on what it is angry about. Sometimes it is small and looks foolish — the anger of traffic jams, of printers that jam, of small daily stupidities. Sometimes it fills the frame entirely — the anger of injustice, of cruelty, of systems designed to harm. Nomura draws it with the understanding that anger is not always wrong, and that teaching children to recognize legitimate rage is more useful than teaching them to be nice.

The Fear Monster (2024)

Technique: Ink illustration, muted colors with sharp contrasts, individual art print

Display: Gallery print, psychological exhibition or children's therapy space

A transparent, shifting creature that takes the shape of whatever is actually frightening in the room — sometimes nothing, sometimes everything.

The Fear Monster is the most honest of Nomura's creatures because it looks like whatever is actually in the room with you. Sometimes it looks like

nothing — transparent, harmless, imaginary. Sometimes it looks like everything — filling all available space, making the room unlivable. The monster cannot be defeated because it is not always wrong. Sometimes there really is something to be afraid of. The monster's job is not to disappear but to help you tell the difference.

Death, Death, Dead (2025)

Technique: Ink illustration on 0.4m x 5m horizontal canvas, mostly monochrome with selective color

Display: Gallery wall installation, viewers walk alongside the piece to experience temporal progression

A single extreme horizontal illustration showing the progression from life to ending: musical notes dying, waves flattening, chess reaching checkmate, cube deconstructing to raw materials.

The 0.4 by 5 meter format is a commitment before a single line is drawn: this is an illustration about things that extend, persist, and then stop. Left to right, the wave becomes a line. The scribble fades. The chess sequence plays to checkmate across the length of the canvas, with the viewer walking alongside the inevitable. The cube deconstruction sequence is the most formally rigorous: first the cube, then its elements displaced, then separated, then seen as flat drawings, then as the actual graphite and medium used to make them. A clock reading NOW appears at the far right. Nomura saves color for the overlapping waves — one of the few uses of it in the whole piece — which makes the color feel like grief, or like survival.

Nadia Al-Rasheed

Born in Mumbai to an Indian father and Mexican mother, and working between Mexico City and Berlin, Al-Rasheed works with materials that resist or amplify force — laser, reflective metals, high-tech cutting tools, ancient weapons — examining the aesthetics of precision, speed, and violence.

Nadia Al-Rasheed grew up between two cultures that understand the relationship between the sacred and the sharp: her Indian father's family, who kept ceremonial kirpans, and her Mexican mother's, who made

offerings with obsidian blades. This collision of devotional traditions and engineering precision shapes every piece she makes. Her work is less interested in representing violence than in examining the tools themselves: the speed of the blade, the precision of the explosive, the camera mounted on an instrument designed to cut. She approaches historical weapons the way engineers approach prototypes — with genuine admiration for the problem-solving and genuine discomfort about what the problem was. Her practice moves between the devotional and the technological, always asking what happens when the sacred gets an upgrade.

Series: Edge Technologies

Reimagined Katana (2023)

Technique: Titanium, carbon fiber, embedded micro-camera, small propellant charges, CNC precision manufacture

Display: Gallery vitrine, displayed alongside a traditional katana for formal comparison

Traditional katanas reimagined with contemporary materials and technologies — titanium blades, embedded cameras, small explosive charges to increase strike velocity.

The katana is already a piece of engineering that spent a thousand years being refined. Al-Rasheed takes it seriously as such. The titanium variant is harder and lighter than tamahagane. The embedded camera raises a question about what you see when you use a weapon and whether you would use it differently if you knew it was recorded. The small propellant charges integrated into the grip would increase strike velocity by a meaningful percentage. Whether this constitutes an improved weapon or a conceptual provocation about what improvement means in a context of harm is, Al-Rasheed suggests, the same question.

Sculptures of Interesting Geometric Shapes (2024)

Technique: Precision CNC fabrication, cast and polished metal, mathematical solid forms

Display: Gallery pedestal series or vitrine display

Sculptures of mathematically notable geometric solids: the rhombicosidodecahedron, the Noperthedron, and rolling triangle mechanisms.

These are, in the most honest possible description, very beautiful math homework. The rhombicosidodecahedron — a solid so visually rich it feels like it is trying to become a sphere and a platonic solid simultaneously — in polished brass is an object you want to hold. The Noperthedron, a less-catalogued solid that challenges the eye's expectation of regularity, sits wrong in a room in a way that is satisfying. The rolling triangles, in motion, produce movement that the eye processes as impossible even while watching it succeed. Al-Rasheed makes no claim that these are profound. She makes only the claim that they are interesting, which is harder to sustain than it sounds.

Krishna's Disc Weapon (2024)

Technique: Titanium, carbon fiber, embedded electronics, CNC precision manufacture, abstract painting backdrop

Display: Gallery wall installation with painting backdrop, elevated display mount

A modernized version of Krishna's Sudarshana Chakra disc weapon reimagined in silicon valley-grade materials, displayed over a powerful abstract painting.

Al-Rasheed is not Hindu. She is not interested in being faithful. She is interested in the idea of the divine weapon upgraded — what the Sudarshana Chakra would look like if designed by aerospace engineers who had also read the Bhagavata Purana. The result is both reverential and presumptuous, an act of creative appropriation that the piece itself seems aware of. It spins. It is very sharp. It is displayed over a painting that makes it look like it arrived from somewhere else entirely, which is exactly correct.

Eternal Feelings (2023)

Technique: Mechanical fist sculpture, ocean-sourced salt, salt recycling system, pedestal installation

Display: Gallery floor or pedestal installation, extended exhibition duration to show accumulation

A mechanical fist continuously pours salt from its grip into a growing mound — Gandhi's fist, offering the salt of the sea that belongs to no nation.

This is Gandhi's fist, opened. Salt falls from it as it did when he walked to the sea in 1930 and took what the British Empire said belonged to them. The salt is real ocean salt — Al-Rasheed sources it from whatever ocean is nearest to the venue — and this geographical specificity matters: the salt in Berlin is Atlantic; the salt in Tokyo is Pacific; the salt in Venice is Adriatic. All of it, according to Gandhi's logic and Al-Rasheed's mechanics, belongs to everyone and no one. The fist could be resistance. Could be offering. Could be the sea releasing itself slowly through a hand that refused to close when told to. The mound grows over the course of the exhibition. The recycling mechanism prevents it from overflowing. Nothing is wasted. The fist keeps giving.
